

IELTS ACADEMIC PREPARATION

Cambridge IELTS 21

4 Practice Tests with Full Answer Key

ACADEMIC TRAINING · INTERMEDIATE LEVEL

Official Cambridge IELTS Tests

Listening Reading Writing Speaking

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Answer blanks. Interactive fields from the online test are printed as numbered dotted lines — e.g. 7..... — write your answer on the line. For multiple-choice questions, tick the box ☐ next to your choice.

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Answer sheets. An IELTS-style answer sheet follows each Listening and Reading test. Transfer your answers there, exactly like on test day.

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CAMBRIDGE IELTS 21

Practice Test 1

Academic · KeenIELTS Offline Practice

Listening

40 questions · approx. 30 minutes + 10 minutes transfer time



Scan to play the test audio

Point your phone camera at the code — the audio opens directly in your browser, no login required. Play it once only, just like the real exam.

<https://keenielts.com/listening-audio/Zg8pgzE0K0Popr8cQR4H>

- Answer all the questions as you listen — the recording is played **once** only.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then transfer them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

SECTION 1

Questions 1-6

Complete the table below.

Write **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

Oyster Bay Sailing Club Courses

Name of course	What you learn	Cost	Other information
Taster day	introduction to sailing	£120 if booking one place	small groups (max 1 people)
Level 1	basic theory e.g. understanding the 2 and tides basic sailing skills including 3 information	£200 4 available for club members all inclusive (plus a useful 5)	a 6 at the end of the course for all participants

Questions 7-10

Complete the notes below.

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

General information

- Participants must be able to swim .
- Bring suitable clothing, a **7** and toiletries (e.g. shampoo).
- There is a **8** at the club.
- Online training **9** are recommended.
- **10** are available for course participants.

SECTION 2

SECTION 2

Questions 11-16

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

Working as a makeup trainee

11. What should trainees always expect to get when working on low budget short films?

- A** travel expenses
- B** a minimum wage
- C** meals

11 (A / B / C)

12. According to the speaker, on big budget films trainees may get experience of

- A** makeup for special effects.
- B** working with different ethnicities.
- C** creating a variety of hair styles.

12 (A / B / C)

13. The speaker says a problem for makeup artists is

- A** dealing with difficult directors.
- B** being shouted at by their supervisor.
- C** waiting around for hours doing nothing.

13 (A / B / C)

14. How did the speaker feel when she met famous actors for the first time?

- A** very shy
- B** very proud
- C** very disappointed

14 (A / B / C)

15. What advice does the speaker give about makeup kits?

- A** Always carry a basic kit with you.
- B** Only buy the best products for a makeup kit.
- C** Ask other makeup artists to check your kit.

15 (A / B / C)

16. What advice does the speaker give about creating a portfolio?

- A** Keep print and digital photos.
- B** Only include a small selection of photos.
- C** Get permission to use photos.

16 (A / B / C)

Questions 17-20

What ability is required for each of the following duties?

Write the correct letter, A, B, or C, next to Questions 17-20.

A	being well-organised
B	being flexible
C	working quickly

Duties

- 17.** Prepping an actor **17** (A / B / C)
- 18.** Continuity **18** (A / B / C)
- 19.** General **19** (A / B / C)
- 20.** Applying makeup **20** (A / B / C)

SECTION 3

SECTION 3

Questions 21-22

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

A	the references to local problems
B	the broad focus of the examples
C	the practical suggestions for solutions
D	the type of issues discussed

E	the implications for government policy
----------	--

21. Which TWO features of the lecture on ocean biodiversity had the greatest impact on the students? **21** (A / B / C / D / E)

22. Which TWO features of the lecture on ocean biodiversity had the greatest impact on the students? **22** (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 23-24

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

A	the team's previous successes
B	its wide geographical scale
C	the use of new technology
D	the extensive statistical evidence
E	the large range of specialists involved

23. Which TWO details about the research project particularly impressed the students?
23 (A / B / C / D / E)

24. Which TWO details about the research project particularly impressed the students?
24 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 25-30

What is the students' opinion of each of the following resources related to ocean biodiversity?

Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-H, next to

Questions 25-30.

Opinions

A	This is aimed at a very specialist audience.
B	This is now rather outdated.
C	This was an effective description of a new danger.
D	This suggests possible ways to improve the situation.
E	This does not give a balanced account.

F	This is too predictable to be useful.
G	This gives insufficient evidence for its claims.
H	This gives a clear explanation of the problems.

Resources

25. Article on invasive lionfish **25** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
26. Documentary on microplastics **26** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
27. Podcast on ocean pollution **27** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
28. Book on coastal ecosystems **28** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
29. Article on metal toxicity **29** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
30. Podcast on floating marine cities **30** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)

SECTION 4

SECTION 4

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below.

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

Sources of rubber

Three resources which are essential for industrial civilisation

- **31**
- fossil fuels
- rubber

Natural rubber

This mainly comes from the Para rubber tree, now cultivated in South-East Asia.

The supply is limited because

- the growth of the tree is **32**
- production cannot easily be adjusted because of increasing or decreasing **33**
- the tree only grows near the **34**
- extracting the latex (rubber) is labour-intensive
- it is very difficult to **35** rubber after production.

New threats include

- lack of genetic diversity, leading to danger of disease caused by a **36**

- a shift to the cultivation of palm oil
- extreme **37** events.

Synthetic rubber

- may be used for engine parts and cooking utensils
- is less **38** than natural rubber
- is unsuitable for many purposes e.g. the tyres of aircraft.

An alternative source of natural rubber

- A wild flower (a type of dandelion) has rubber in its **39**
- It can be grown in many locations and does not require good **40**



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.
<https://keenielts.com/check/listening/Zg8pgzE0K0Popr8cQR4H>

Listening Answer Sheet — Practice Test 1



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

L-Zg8pgzE0K0Popr8cQR4H

Name: _____ Date: _____

1 _____	21 _____
2 _____	22 _____
3 _____	23 _____
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5 _____	25 _____
6 _____	26 _____
7 _____	27 _____
8 _____	28 _____
9 _____	29 _____
10 _____	30 _____
11 _____	31 _____
12 _____	32 _____
13 _____	33 _____
14 _____	34 _____
15 _____	35 _____
16 _____	36 _____
17 _____	37 _____
18 _____	38 _____
19 _____	39 _____
20 _____	40 _____

Reading

40 questions • 60 minutes

- Read each passage and answer the questions that follow. No extra time is given to transfer answers.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then copy them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

THE DAVIES SISTERS

The Davies Sisters

Between 1908 and 1924, Gwendoline and Margaret Davies amassed one of the largest collections of late-nineteenth and early-twentieth-century French paintings in Britain

Gwendoline (1882-1951) and Margaret (1884-1963) Davies were the granddaughters of David Davies, a Welshman who amassed a fortune in the shipping and mining industries. In 1907, when Gwendoline came into her inheritance (Margaret would follow in 1909), the sisters were said to be the wealthiest unmarried women in Britain. Their religious upbringing in rural Wales gave them a deep sense of social responsibility and they chose to use their inheritance for cultural and philanthropic purposes.

While there was no real family history of art collecting, the sisters' education was rigorously geared toward such pursuits. Their London school focused on cultural rather than academic study, and they travelled extensively with their governess, Jane Blaker, visiting art galleries and making extensive notes on the collections there.

The sisters began to make regular art purchases from 1908, which roughly coincided with the dates of their inheritance. They took advice from various people, including the art dealer Hugh Blaker (the brother of Jane Blaker) and David Croal Thompson, who was also an art dealer. While it was long assumed that these men were largely responsible for the nature of the sisters' collection, it has recently been accepted that Gwendoline and Margaret retained a far more active role in the process.

The sisters' journals reveal their preference for Old Master paintings. Yet they initially made very few attempts to secure any such works. While the sisters were wealthy in relative terms, their income was nothing compared to the fortunes of American art collectors of this period, such as J. Pierpont Morgan. Quite simply, high quality Old Master works were, if not beyond their means, then beyond what they were willing to pay for them. Instead, their early purchases were of the fashionable, safe variety, and included, for example, paintings by the French artist Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot.

However, it was only a few years before their collecting took a new direction and they turned to the work of the French Impressionists. We know that Hugh Blaker, as a champion of contemporary French art had a hand in the decision, and we know also that they would have seen examples on their various trips to Paris. Whatever the precise reason for this change, their first purchases of Impressionist art, made in October 1912, were scenes of Venice by the French artist Claude Monet. Over the next 12 years, the sisters amassed the bulk of their Impressionist collection, including six further works by Monet, two more by Manet, and three by Renoir, including his well-known painting *La Parisienne*.

The First World War (1914-1918) played a part in the development of the sisters' collection. Their initial response to the war effort was to finance the safe passage of artists from occupied Belgium to Wales, as a

humanitarian act, but also with the hope of establishing a vibrant artists' community in the area. Later in the conflict, both sisters decided to volunteer at a canteen for troops at Troyes, in northern France; Gwendoline in 1916, followed by Margaret in 1917.

It was tedious and distressing work, which would have a permanent effect on Gwendoline's health. Yet on one of numerous trips to nearby Paris, she visited the Bernheim-Jeune Gallery. Here she acquired two works by Cezanne - Provençal Landscape and The François Zola Dam. The paintings were shipped directly to Bath, England, where they became the first works by Cezanne to go on display in a public gallery in Britain.

Commentators have often described the sisters as unlikely pioneer collectors. Much is made of their isolation in rural Wales and the fact that they didn't make friends with artists or gallery owners. Yet they didn't feel obliged to follow fashionable tastes and were free to pursue their own preferences. Although they relied on a trusted circle of advisers, they made frequent trips to London and Paris, and also regularly had paintings sent to their home for consideration.

By the early 1920s, Gwendoline felt increasingly uncomfortable buying art works when faced with the poverty and social upheaval created by the First World War. Her philanthropic pursuits then became focused almost exclusively on social causes and the development of the sisters' home at Gregynog Hall into a conference center and venue for the Gregynog Festival of Music and Poetry. Gwendoline made her final art purchase in March 1926. Margaret also stopped collecting around this time, but started again in the 1930s acquiring, on a relatively small scale, work by contemporary British artists.

The sisters collected French Impressionist paintings at a time when such art was routinely ignored by individuals and institutions alike. The Gwendoline and Margaret Davies collection, donated in 1951 and 1963 respectively to the National Museum Wales, contains major examples of work by leading French Impressionists. In collecting paintings that they loved, the sisters created a lasting and meaningful cultural legacy for the people of Wales and beyond.

Questions 1-7

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 1-7 on your answer sheet.

Gwendoline and Margaret Davies
Family and early life
their grandfather's wealth came from 1 and transportation businesses
their upbringing gave them a sense of social responsibility
their 2 was designed to give them an interest in activities such as collecting art
their governess took them on trips to art galleries
they took lengthy 3 about the things they saw in art galleries
The sisters as art collectors
their 4 showed they liked Old Master paintings, but they were expensive to buy
their early purchases were safe, popular paintings
the first Impressionist paintings they bought showed places in 5
Impact of First World War
they helped bring artists from Belgium to Wales
they worked in a 6 for soldiers in France
Opinions about the sisters as art collectors
were not considered typical collectors - they lived in isolation in the countryside and did not have any 7 who were artists

Questions 8-13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 8-13 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

8. The Davies sisters' childhood influenced the way they decided to use their wealth.

8 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

9. The Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot paintings in the Davies sisters' collection were purchased from a gallery in France. **9** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

10. Hugh Blaker opposed the Davies sisters' decision to buy art by French Impressionists.

10 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

11. The exhibition of Cezanne paintings at the Bath gallery was very popular with the public.

11 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

12. The impact of the First World War encouraged Gwendoline to reconsider her interest in collecting art. **12** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

13. The Davies sisters bought French Impressionist art during a period when very few people were doing so. **13** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

WHY WE NEED SILENCE

Why we need silence

A Humans are finely attuned to noise, and for good reason. From an evolutionary perspective, sounds give us vital information, helping us navigate the world and avoid danger. To help ensure loud or unexpected noises get the attention they deserve, our internal chemistry alters in response to them. Our blood pressure goes up, muscles tense and glands release hormones that prepare us for fight or flight. In the short term, this is a good thing. When we are exposed to too much noise over the long term, however, those responses can lead to a multitude of health issues, from sleep disturbance to even cardiovascular disease.

B The World Health Organization has recently designated excessive noise as an 'underestimated threat' to public health, and has said that people living in cities such as Mumbai, Tokyo and Buenos Aires are being exposed to far more than the recommended 40 decibels of noise at night. A report from the European Environment Agency concluded that noise was an ongoing and widespread issue in Europe, with at least 1 in 5 people consistently exposed to levels considered harmful to health. 'There are no "earlids" that can protect your brain from noise,' says Nick Antonio, an acoustic consultant who has contributed to the British and international standards for noise.

C The good news is that several cities have been working to turn the volume down. One of the first to do so was London. 'By providing recommendations for quieter buses, reducing noise from roads and also controlling noise from aircraft, they were able to make the city quieter,' says Antonio. Other cities have introduced noise-reducing road coatings, for instance, alongside greenery that muffles sound. Some solutions are more specific: Washington DC's ban on petrol-powered leaf blowers came into effect recently, while in New York City, legislation has been approved to fine people who modify their vehicles to make them noisier. 'People are seeing the benefits of these more quiet environments in their cities,' Antonio says. 'I expect we will see much more of this in the future.'

D Researchers are also seeking to understand what aspects of silent experiences are most beneficial to our health. One of the best-researched is the flotation tank: a lightproof, soundproof tank of salt water in which a person floats as a form of deep relaxation. While some people experience altered perception in the tanks, involving subtle humming sounds and visual effects, these effects are benign and do not detract from the benefits of the experience, says Justin Feinstein, a clinical neuropsychologist. 'When you don't have external sensory stimuli coming in, the brain tries to fill the void to make sense of this dark and silent world,' he explains. 'In these tanks, some people can even hear the sound of their eyes blinking,' says Feinstein. 'But it is the ability to focus on the breath that helps people reach a relaxed or meditative state.'

E To further explore flotation tanks as a therapeutic tool, Feinstein and his colleagues recruited 50 people with a variety of conditions related to stress and had them answer a questionnaire prior to and following a flotation session. Participants reported decreases in muscle tension, pain and symptoms of their conditions after a single, 1-hour float, alongside an increase in feelings of relaxation and overall wellbeing. Less is known about what effects sensory deprivation can have on the brain. To investigate, Feinstein's team had 48 people participate in either three 90-minute float sessions or three 90-minute periods of relaxing on a chair which reclined. Participants had their brains scanned using functional magnetic resonance imaging at the beginning and end of the trial. Float sessions uniquely decreased activity in the default mode network (DMN), a collection of brain regions commonly linked with depression. Feinstein

says it is an exciting finding, because flotation tanks seem to offer a way of 'resetting' our nervous system to prevent it from getting out of balance.

F Neurobiologist Tai Dotan Ben-Soussan is also an advocate of silence as a therapy. 'When we find ways to be quiet, we are not only quiet in our environment, but quiet in our inner selves,' she explains. 'This allows us to be more aware of what is happening around us and what the situation may require from us so we can provide [a more] adequate response.'

Not everyone will benefit from silence to the same extent, but Ben-Soussan says one characteristic is key: the person must need to want to engage in the experience. 'We see from animal models and human studies that volition and intentionality is important,' she says. 'When people do not want silence, it can be very distressing.'

G Eric Pfeifer, a psychotherapy researcher, also concedes that some people may not benefit from silence, particularly those who are in a heightened state of stress. 'People in these states may not be able to relax or calm down in a silent condition,' he says. Professional guidance can be useful, he adds, allowing people to approach silence slowly so that they can gradually enjoy the benefits. And Pfeifer is convinced that silence is more attainable in everyday life than people think. First, complete silence isn't necessary. In a recent study, he found that participants reported more relaxation and less boredom when they sat quietly in an outdoor garden compared with a completely silent room. Second, Pfeifer believes we don't need a lot of silence to gain benefits. 'You don't need to spend hours in silence,' he says. 'It is likely better to have more frequency of silence for a few minutes at a time than a longer period of silence only once a week. Just finding those places in your daily life where you can find some silence ... can make a big difference.'

Questions 14-17

Reading Passage 2 has seven sections, A-G.

Which section contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, A-G, in boxes 14-17 on your answer sheet.

14. examples of strategies to decrease the noise that the public are exposed to

14 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

15. data indicating the extent of the problem of excessive noise

15 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

16. a description of physiological changes in our bodies when we hear sudden noises

16 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

17. evidence that a relatively quiet environment can be more beneficial than a totally silent one

17 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

Questions 18-21

Complete the summary below.

Choose ONE WORD ONLY from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 18-21 on your answer sheet.

Flotation Tanks

According to Justin Feinstein, flotation tanks allow people to concentrate on their own

18 18, which helps them relax and enables them to meditate.

Feinstein and his colleagues conducted an experiment in which 50 people, who were all suffering from stress and related issues, were given a 19 19 to complete before and after using a flotation tank. Participants reported a reduction in their symptoms after an hour in the tank, together with signs of relaxation and improved general 20 20

In another experiment, the researchers had 48 people spend periods of 90 minutes either lying back in a chair or floating in a tank. Brain scans then revealed that those people who had been in a tank had decreased activity in parts of the brain associated with 21 21

Questions 22-26

Look at the following statements (Questions 22-26) and the list of people below.

Match each statement with the correct person, A, B, C or D.

Write the correct letter, A, B, C or D, in boxes 22-26 on your answer sheet.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

A	Nick Antonio
B	Justin Feinstein

C	Tal Dotan Ben-Soussan
D	Eric Pfeifer

22. It is unpleasant and upsetting for people to be placed in a silent environment against their will.

22 (A / B / C / D)

23. The trend towards creating quieter urban locations is likely to increase in the coming years.

23 (A / B / C / D)

24. When our body's senses are completely deprived of input, our minds compensate for this by creating the illusion of images and sounds. **24** (A / B / C / D)

25. Even a short amount of silent time can have a positive impact. **25** (A / B / C / D)

26. External and internal quietness makes us more conscious of events occurring in our surroundings and helps us react appropriately to these events. **26** (A / B / C / D)

BOOK REVIEW: THE WORLD OF SUGAR BY ULBE BOSMA**Book review: The World of Sugar by Ulbe Bosma**

Ulbe Bosma's *The World of Sugar* is a genuinely global history. Bosma discusses all the sugar-growing places of the world, beginning with Cuba and Java, the largest exporters of the early 20th century. But this is a history not just of cane sugar but also of beet sugar, an equally important form of traded sugar over the last hundred years. Beet sugar is grown mainly in Europe and the United States. It has also been massively subsidised and sold at artificially low prices on world markets, threatening the livelihood of producers of cane sugar.

Bosma's discussion of the sugar market in Britain gives a sense of the book's range. The sweet-toothed British first bought cane sugar from their own slavery-dependent colonial plantations. Following the abolition of slavery in the British Empire, cane sugar was imported to Britain from places which retained the practice, such as Cuba and Brazil. Towards the end of the 19th century, the British started to import beet sugar from continental Europe. Only in the 20th century was there a move to develop a national beet sugar industry.

The book provides a global labour history, investigating the wide range of labour regimes associated with growing sugar. Contrary to popular belief, cane sugar production was never just restricted to large, dedicated plantations owned by rich men. For example, in Java, a huge exporter of sugar in the early 20th century, sugar cane was grown together with rice in an extraordinarily labour-intensive way by small farmers.

The World of Sugar is also a story of similarity and continuity in sugar cultivation. For example, imported labour has been used for much large-scale production. German beet fields employed Polish workers; Mexicans and many others, including Sicilians, were vital to US sugar production. Cane cutting, Bosma shows, remains a poorly paid and brutal business to this day in many places in the world. But as well as this, the book is about the continuity of the use of traditional methods on small farms. In the mid 20th-century, this type of sugar production dominated in South Asia and Latin America.

This is also a history of capitalists and sugar dynasties, as well as corporations that in some cases have remained influential over very long periods. Great firms and great interests have had profound influence on the policies of states. In many places - not just the British Caribbean but Cuba and the Philippines too - a powerful sugar bourgeoisie played a major role in politics and their interests were consequently protected by trade barriers and subsidies. In the battle for control of the industry, it was inevitably the poor countries which came off worse. All this is explored by Bosma with wonderful subtlety and control.

But sugar production was never just a matter of agriculture. It also involved the extraction, close to the place of harvest, of sucrose from the sugar plant, a process which required machinery powered by humans, animals, wind or steam. Further processes involved boiling (from the 19th century, this often involved vacuum systems) and the separation of sugar from other materials in a process known as refinement. From very early on, sugar production was an energy-intensive industrial process, mostly taking place in the countryside and in refineries in centres of consumption, both small and large. The growth of the industry entailed a very rapid diffusion of ideas and techniques from one country to another. Cuba, for example, developed an extraordinarily dense system of railways to transport workers and cane, as well as steam-powered sugar factories. Particular varieties of cane sugar and beet sugar spread very rapidly across the world, in accordance with local needs and demands.

Where once only tiny quantities of sugar could be produced, now new techniques, varieties, fertilisers, irrigation systems and much more have turned gleaming white sugar into a ubiquitous chemical. Over the same time, there has been a massive increase in consumption. Once regarded as a luxury, sugar came to be promoted as a valuable source of energy. But as the consumption of sugar has increased, so has the harm it does, whether to people's teeth or weight. In the face of appalling obstruction from the sugar industry to attempts to reduce consumption, some countries have been forced to tax sugar in order to bring that about. The sugar industry has a history of attacking its critics and, when it comes to obesity, of trying to blame fats, and lack of exercise and self-control. And the recent past has seen worrying new developments in mass sweetening. High-fructose corn syrup made from maize using an enzymatic process invented in Japan in the 1960s has a similar number of calories to table sugar but is far cheaper to produce. It is now widely consumed, having been adopted in the making of soft drinks and a large number of processed foods, and is regarded as a leading cause of obesity.

This is a wonderfully rich book, a model of global history, the history of production and the history of capitalism. Bosma avoids outbursts of emotion, celebratory or critical, even if they might have made his analysis of the multiple tragedies involving sugar all the more powerful. He shows that we could always have done without sugar and that today we have many alternative sources of sweetness. Yet many of the poorest people in the world still depend on it to make a living.

Questions 27-30

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**.

Write the correct letter in boxes 27-30 on your answer sheet.

27. What does the reviewer suggest about the cultivation and trading of sugar in the first paragraph?

- A** Sugar has played a major role in international relations.
- B** Beet sugar has been made more internationally competitive.
- C** Cane sugar is thought to be of superior quality to beet sugar.
- D** New locations for cultivating sugar have increased production.

27 (A / B / C / D)

28. In the second paragraph, when discussing the sugar market in Britain, the reviewer stresses

- A** how the sources used changed over time.
- B** how developments in agriculture affected trade.
- C** the increased demand for sugar over the years.
- D** the growing support for ethical methods of cultivation.

28 (A / B / C / D)

29. What is the reviewer doing in the third paragraph?

- A** describing an efficient approach to sugar cultivation
- B** explaining why the use of sugar plantations declined
- C** addressing a misconception about the growing of sugar cane
- D** evaluating different approaches to the cultivation of sugar cane

29 (A / B / C / D)

30. In the final paragraph, what does the reviewer suggest is the overall message of Bosma's book?

- A** Sugar is a harmful and unnecessary product.
- B** Economic pressure is needed to control sugar production.
- C** Conditions for workers in sugar production should be improved.
- D** Intensive marketing of sugar has had disastrous consequences.

30 (A / B / C / D)

Questions 31-36

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A-I**, below.

Write the correct letter, **A-I**, in boxes 31-36 on your answer sheet.

A	national governments
B	agricultural developments
C	less wealthy nations
D	untrained workers
E	small-scale cultivation
F	outdated methods
G	financial controls
H	migrant workers
I	powerful individuals and businesses

Sugar cultivation and production

The book *The World of Sugar* points out the similarities in the way that sugar was cultivated around the world. In the big industries in both Germany and the US, sugar farming depended on **31** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I). However, in other parts of the world such as South

Asia and Latin America, **32** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) continued.

Sugar production has also involved **33** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) who were eager to protect their

markets. In countries such as Cuba the sugar industry therefore had a major influence on **34** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) .

To support the interests of sugar producers, **35** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) were established. As a result

of this, **36** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) were penalised.

Questions 37-40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 37-40 on your answer sheet, write

YES if the statement agrees with the views of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the views of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

37. Sugar has now become available in large quantities due to a range of agricultural developments.

37 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

38. Advertisers initially marketed sugar as a luxury product. **38** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

39. The invention of high-fructose corn syrup was a positive development.

39 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

40. High-fructose corn syrup is an ingredient in many processed foods.

40 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/reading/wFZQkQtMMCWPatHMJe5x>

Reading Answer Sheet — Practice Test 1



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

R-wFZQkQtMMCWPatHMJe5x

Name: _____ Date: _____

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11	_____	31	_____
12	_____	32	_____
13	_____	33	_____
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15	_____	35	_____
16	_____	36	_____
17	_____	37	_____
18	_____	38	_____
19	_____	39	_____
20	_____	40	_____

Writing

2 tasks · 60 minutes

TASK 1

NUMBER OF JOBS IN FOUR SECTORS OF THE ECONOMY IN THE US, 1960-2020

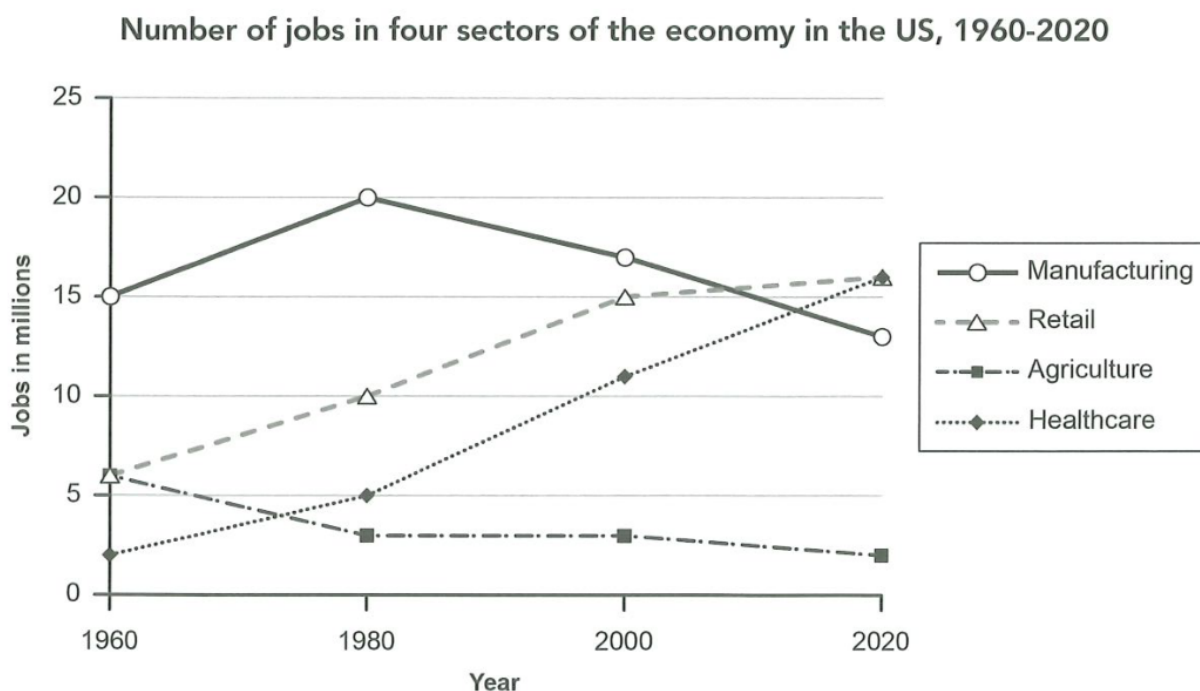
You should **spend about 20 minutes** on this task.

Write at least 150 words.

The graph below gives information about the number of jobs in four sectors of the economy in the US between 1960 and 2020.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Number of jobs in four sectors of the economy in the US, 1960-2020



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 1? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 1 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/xWhDlG02Z9ws4G9RQGWE?task=T1>



Sheet ID: W-xWhDIgU2Z9ws4G9RQGWE-T1

TASK 2

PROVIDING HOMES IN LARGE CITIES

You should **spend about 40 minutes** on this task.

Write at least 250 words.

The best way to provide enough homes in large cities is to build tall apartment blocks.

To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 2? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 1 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/xWhDlgU2Z9ws4G9RQGWE?task=T2>



Sheet ID: W-xWhDIgU2Z9ws4G9RQGWE-T2

Speaking

3 parts · 11–14 minutes · practise aloud, ideally with a partner or recorder

PART 1

HAIRSTYLES

1. Can you tell me your full name, please?
2. What can I call you?
3. Where are you from?
4. Do you work, or are you a student?
5. Where do you go to get a haircut?
6. Have you changed your hairstyle recently?
7. Would you ever change the colour of your hair?
8. Do you enjoy going to the hairdresser/barber?

PART 2

USING INFORMATION FOR TOURISTS

Describe a time when you used information for tourists, for example from a guidebook or online.

You should say:

- where you got this information
- what place this information was about
- what information you got

and explain whether this information was very helpful for you.

You have one minute to prepare. Then speak for 1–2 minutes.

PART 3

DIFFERENT TYPES OF HOLIDAYS AND TOURIST ATTRACTIONS

1. What are the most popular kinds of holidays for people from your country to go on?
2. Do you think most people prefer to have a holiday abroad rather than in their own country?
3. Why do some people want to do absolutely nothing when they go away on holiday?
4. What are the kinds of tourist attraction that visitors to your country like to see?
5. Do you think tourist attractions such as museums should be free for local people to visit?

6. What can make a tourist attraction disappointing for visitors?



Scan to record & get an AI band score

Practised these questions aloud? Scan to record your answers on your phone and get an instant AI speaking evaluation across all four criteria.

<https://keenielts.com/check/speaking/QWBkxsN3bOTTsS31KUZ>

CAMBRIDGE IELTS 21

Practice Test 2

Academic · KeenIELTS Offline Practice

Listening

40 questions · approx. 30 minutes + 10 minutes transfer time



Scan to play the test audio

Point your phone camera at the code — the audio opens directly in your browser, no login required. Play it once only, just like the real exam.

<https://keenielts.com/listening-audio/095cvjvYeGZ6CzH8VHVO>

- Answer all the questions as you listen — the recording is played **once** only.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then transfer them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

SECTION 1

Questions 1-10

Complete the table below.

Write **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

One-day classes at Steynford College

Course	Date	Cost	Notes
Vietnamese food	1.....	£59	It provides information on the use of herbs. There are no places at present.
Bread making	20 March	£ 2.....	There is also an extra charge for ingredients. Participants make white bread, sourdough and 3.....
Face massage	23 February	£35	The teacher trained in 4..... Bring a 5.....
Candle making	6.....	£52	Only 7..... ingredients are used.

			The candles can be used as presents.
Silk painting	18 May	£ 8	Bring an apron or old 9
DIY for beginners	24 February	£125	Learn how to • use a drill, saw and 10 • put up a shelf .

SECTION 2

SECTION 2

Questions 11-12

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.

A	Stop for lunch in an ancient town.
B	Don't miss the ruins of a certain building.
C	Catch a boat to the start of this walk.
D	Be careful of the steep and rocky paths.
E	Don't worry about getting lost.

11. Which **TWO** pieces of advice are given about the Marsden Coastal Walk?

11 (A / B / C / D / E)

12. Which **TWO** pieces of advice are given about the Marsden Coastal Walk?

12 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 13-14

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.

A	This walk is mostly downhill.
B	The paths can get busy during the day.
C	This is a circular walk.
D	A tower stands on the site of an older structure.
E	There are far-reaching views the whole way.

13. Which TWO things are said about the Melby Heritage Walk? **13** (A / B / C / D / E)

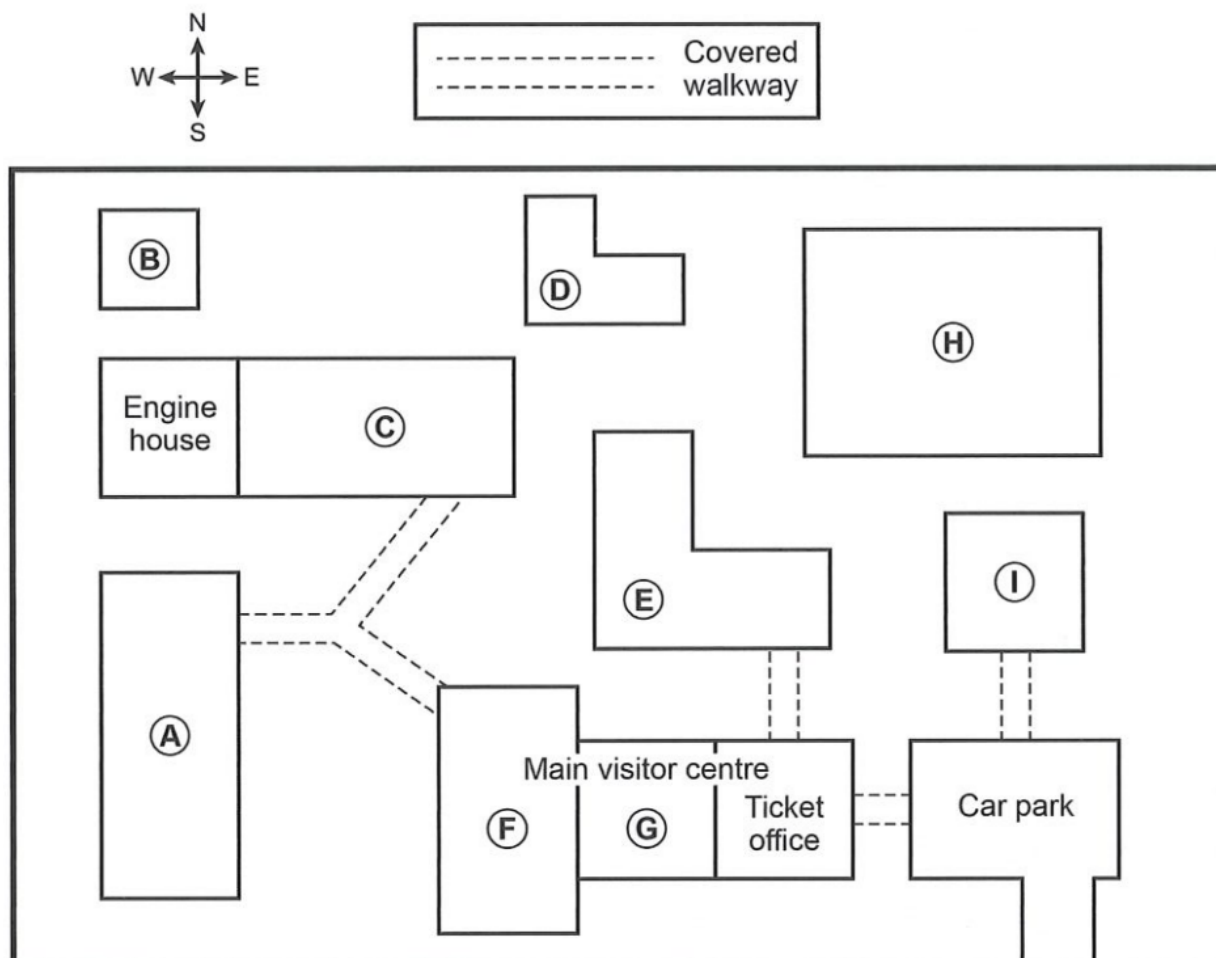
14. Which TWO things are said about the Melby Heritage Walk? **14** (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 15-20

Label the map below.

Write the correct letter, A-I, next to Questions 15-20.

Melby Coal Mine



15. Exhibition **15** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

16. Baths **16** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

17. Tools **17** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

18. Vehicles **18** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

19. Ponies **19** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

20. Education centre **20** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

SECTION 3

SECTION 3

Questions 21-22

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

A	the amount of plastic in the ocean
B	the number of diseases caused by contaminated food
C	the amount of food that is wasted
D	the number of people who are obese
E	the result of treating animals with antibiotics

21. Which TWO facts in the sessions on food safety were new information for Nadia and Fergus?

21 (A / B / C / D / E)

22. Which TWO facts in the sessions on food safety were new information for Nadia and Fergus?

22 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 23-24

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

A	the new technology it used
B	the publicity it received
C	the use of multiple tests on food items
D	the variety of dietary requirements included
E	the way information was made widely accessible

23. Which TWO features of a project aiming to prevent food fraud impressed Fergus?

23 (A / B / C / D / E)

24. Which TWO features of a project aiming to prevent food fraud impressed Fergus?

24 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 25-26

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

A	sustainable fishing
----------	---------------------

B	targeted nutrition
C	global differences in consumption
D	sustainable agriculture
E	digital technology and food

25. Which TWO topics do both students recommend should be included in the course?

25 (A / B / C / D / E)

26. Which TWO topics do both students recommend should be included in the course?

26 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 27-30

Complete the flow-chart below.

Choose FOUR answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-F, next to Questions 27-30.

A	This was challenging but enjoyable.
B	This led to some disagreement.
C	This was easy to decide on.
D	This was helped by the guidelines provided.
E	This seemed like an unnecessary stage.
F	This involved selecting a new ingredient.

Student project: developing a new food product



30 (A / B / C / D / E / F)

SECTION 4

SECTION 4

Questions 31–40

Complete the notes below.

Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

Challenges facing the cruise ship industry

Problems with overtourism

- 31 is one of the worst problems.
- A tourist 32 is being introduced in some cities to reduce numbers, e.g. Barcelona.
- Bruges: action was taken to limit day trips from the nearby port because the city was becoming a 'theme park' (e.g. many shops were only stocking 33 and souvenirs).
- Dubrovnik: limits the number of tourists by managing the 34 of cruise ship arrivals.

Problems of perception

- Cruises are generally associated with the elderly.
- There is an assumption about the 35 of cruises.
- People think there may be too many 36

Solutions

Cruise lines are attracting younger customers by:

- becoming more sustainable e.g. using hybrid engines.
- having a wide range of activities e.g. boxing, 37 and well-being programmes.
- offering a diverse selection of food including 38 options.
- providing reliable 39
- improving marketing on social media with high quality 40



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/listening/095cvjvYeGZ6CzH8VHVO>

Listening Answer Sheet — Practice Test 2



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

L-095cvJvYeGZ6CzH8VHVO

Name: _____ Date: _____

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11	_____	31	_____
12	_____	32	_____
13	_____	33	_____
14	_____	34	_____
15	_____	35	_____
16	_____	36	_____
17	_____	37	_____
18	_____	38	_____
19	_____	39	_____
20	_____	40	_____

Reading

40 questions · 60 minutes

- Read each passage and answer the questions that follow. No extra time is given to transfer answers.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then copy them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

DO ANIMALS DREAM?

Do animals dream?

Studies using electrodes attached to the heads of sleepers have shown that when we sleep, we do so in two ways that alternate throughout the night. The first is rapid eye movement (REM) or active sleep. During this stage our eyes move, even though our eyelids are closed. Our muscles also twitch slightly, though they are largely paralysed so we don't hurt ourselves. In contrast, we also engage in non-REM sleep, during which we barely move at all. Most dream states, and certainly those with the most vivid dreams, happen during REM sleep.

There's some evidence that other mammals may also dream. For example, researchers compared the brain patterns of rats running through a maze when awake with their brain patterns during REM sleep. They found the patterns were very similar and concluded that the sleeping rats were dreaming about going through the maze.

But finding evidence of dreaming in non-mammals has proved more difficult. Their brains are very different from those of humans, and it can often be difficult to record their activity while they are sleeping. Recently, however, researchers succeeded in recording brain activity in sleeping pigeons. As in mammals, the recordings revealed both REM and non-REM sleep. Intriguingly, REM sleep activity was high in brain regions involved in processing visual information, especially images related to physical activities such as flying, which suggests that this may possibly be what the pigeons were dreaming about.

That said, dreaming and REM sleep are unlikely to be universal in the animal kingdom. For example, sponges don't have brains, so they lack the machinery for dreaming. There are also some animals with unusual sleep patterns. These include whales and dolphins, which do not shut down their entire brain when they sleep, but only half of it, keeping the rest awake. They also show no sign of REM sleep, suggesting that they may only experience non-REM dreams, which are less vivid. This is surprising because we tend to think of whales and dolphins as having complex inner lives. It's thought that they don't experience REM sleep because during REM sleep animals are more vulnerable to extremes of temperature.

Nevertheless, in many cases REM sleep does seem to have benefits. Growing evidence from birds and mammals suggests that REM sleep and dreaming are important for forming memories and learning. It is believed that when events are replayed in dreams, this helps to integrate memories into longer-term storage. As soon as animals evolved moderately complex lifestyles, they would have needed to dream in order to manage these lifestyles.

However, we still don't understand how this outward behaviour relates to internal experience. It seems impossible to know what it is like to be a rat or a pigeon, let alone imagine their dreamscapes. We are

quick to interpret the twitching limbs and quiet barks of sleeping dogs, but the truth is that we don't know if there is an internal experience of chasing rabbits that comes along with that.

Another non-human dreamer offers insight here. In 2019, while making a documentary, David Scheel of Alaska Pacific University in the USA housed an octopus named Heidi in a tank in his living room. At one point, in the middle of the night, Heidi seemed to dream: her limbs and head moved, and her skin rapidly changed colour, as though she was pursuing a crab.

Similarly, a report recently emerged of a sleeping octopus apparently having a nightmare. Costello, as the octopus was called, thrashed around, extended his mantle as if trying to make himself look bigger, and squirted ink as though he were being attacked by a predator. The nightmare study is intriguing, says Scheel, but is only based on one animal. He argues that as well as outward behaviour, brain imaging is needed to show that the octopuses are replaying sequences of activities from their waking lives in dreams.

The trouble is that we will never be able to experience any animal's dreams. That goes for other humans' dreams too. But we can try to imagine what these dreamscapes are like by meeting animals on their own terms. For example, vision is the dominant sense for many humans, and so our dreams are heavily visual too. Dogs primarily navigate the world using smell while spiders rely much more on vibrations.

It is likely that dreaming has served multiple purposes since the first complex animals evolved. And if this is the case, it is possible that better understanding of these purposes might shed light on the true purpose of our own dreams.

Questions 1-5

Complete the table below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 1-5 on your answer sheet.

Research into sleep and dreaming

	Research findings	Comment
Humans	- humans experience REM sleep and non-REM sleep - in REM sleep, the eyes and muscles move	
1	similar brain patterns were observed when active and sleeping	indicative of dreaming
Pigeons	when sleeping, pigeons displayed activity in parts of the brain that deal with 2 input	may have been dreaming of flying
Whales and dolphins	- still have 3 their brain awake when they sleep - don't experience REM sleep, as this could affect their sensitivity to 4	their dreams are probably not very 5

Questions 6-13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 6-13 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

6. Dreaming about past experiences helps us to create lasting memories of them.

6 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

7. It is now possible to tell what type of dream a dog is having.

7 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

8. David Scheel's documentary was influential on other research into the sleeping patterns of octopuses. **8** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
9. While it was asleep, the octopus called Costello reacted as if it was hunting.
9 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
10. Scheel believes more research into octopuses' dreams should be carried out.
10 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
11. We may soon be able to share the dreams of other human beings.
11 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
12. Hearing may be an important part of the dreams of some animals.
12 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
13. Interest in the reasons why humans dream has increased greatly in recent times.
13 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

MAPUNGUBWE

Mapungubwe

Located in southern Africa just below the Limpopo River, the kingdom of Mapungubwe, flourished between the 11th and 13th century CE

A Mapungubwe, which was one of the first states in southern Africa, was formed by Bantu-speaking peoples who were farmers. The area controlled by the rulers of Mapungubwe had at its heart a large sandstone plateau, which was easily defended due to its inaccessibility. As with other kingdoms in the region of southern Africa, cattle herding and other types of farming brought plenty of food and a surplus that could be traded for needed goods. Archaeology has revealed extensive layers of bones and manure, which indicate that from the 9th century CE there were large cattle herds, the traditional source of political power in southern African communities. The archaeological record for the 10th century shows a marked increase in the number of domesticated cattle in the area as well as cotton cultivation and weaving, as indicated by abundant finds of spindle whorls.

B The total population of Mapungubwe at its peak in the mid-13th century was around 5,000 people. The chief or king of Mapungubwe was likely the wealthiest individual in the society, and would have owned more cattle and precious materials than anyone else. The king and his advisers dwelt in a stone enclosure composed of stone walls and housing built on the highest level of the community's territory, a natural sandstone hill which is some 30 metres high and 100 metres in length. Occupation on the hill dates from the 11th century and the entire complex was surrounded by a wooden palisade*, as indicated by postholes made in the rock. The rest of the community lived in mud and thatch housing spread out below the hill, although there is one stone structure here. This settlement, known as Babandyanalo, covers around 5 hectares (12.3 acres) and predates the hilltop structures.

C The kings of Mapungubwe were buried at the top of the hill site in a demarcated area away from the dwellings, while other members of the community were buried at the surrounding valley level. A wooden staircase connected the two levels, the sockets for the steps being clearly visible in the sandstone cliff face. There were some grander residences dotted around the outskirts of Babandyanalo, and these probably belonged to male relatives of the king. There are many other smaller but still impressive sites across the Mapungubwe plateau, which are located anywhere from 15 to 100 kilometres from the major hill site. Containing stone residences and walls, they likely belonged to local chiefs who acted as servants to the king.

D The Mapungubwe plateau has a very high number of carnivore animal remains and ivory splinters, suggesting that the skins of these large animals and ivory elephant tusks were accumulated, probably for trade with coastal areas reached by the Limpopo River. The presence of glass beads, almost certainly from India, indicate there was trade of some sort with other states on the coast who, in turn, traded with merchants travelling from India by sea. Mapungubwe also benefitted from locally-sourced copper and the gold trade as it passed from the kingdom of Great Zimbabwe (12-15th century), situated to the north of Mapungubwe, to the coastal city of Kosala. It is likely that trade links led to a strengthening of political authority in order to control and even monopolise these lucrative interregional connections.

E Archaeological discoveries reveal that pottery was produced on a scale large enough to suggest the presence of professional potters, and is another indicator of the prosperity of Mapungubwe society. Archaeological finds include spherical vessels with short necks, beakers, and bowls, many of which have decorative stamps. There are also ceramic discs, and whistles. In addition, cattle, sheep, and goat

figurines, and small figures of highly stylised humans with elongated bodies and short limbs have been found. The figures may have been used in ceremonies as offerings to ancestors, but their precise function is not known. Other discoveries include small jewellery items made from locally sourced copper.

F Beautifully decorated artefacts made of gold have also been found at Mapungubwe. A type of decoration, found nowhere else except Great Zimbabwe, involved the crafting of gold into small rectangular sheets and carving geometrical patterns into it. These sheets were then used to cover wooden objects (which have not survived) using small tacks, also made of gold. One such object that has been discovered may have been a sceptre, while additional evidence of local gold-working is a rhinoceros figurine made from small hammered sheets, and thousands of small gold beads. These objects were all found at the royal burial site and date to c. 1150. They are the first known indicators that gold had an intrinsic value of its own (as opposed to that of a currency) in southern Africa.

G The kingdom of Mapungubwe was already in decline by the late 13th century, probably because overpopulation placed too much stress on local resources, a situation that may have been brought to a crisis point by a series of droughts. Trade routes may also have shifted northwards. Certainly, the areas that now prospered were to the north, such as Great Zimbabwe.

Questions 14-19

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, A-G.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, A-G, in boxes 14-19 on your answer sheet.

14. a mention of the uncertainty regarding the purpose of certain objects

14 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

15. the likelihood that a climatic factor increased the problems Mapungubwe faced

15 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

16. a mention of the location where members of the king's family are thought to have lived

16 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

17. a reference to people who brought goods by ship 17 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

18. an estimate of the size to which the Mapungubwe community grew

18 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

19. a mention of agricultural produce being exchanged for other items

19 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

Questions 20-21

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

Write the correct letters in boxes 20 and 21 on your answer sheet.

20. The archaeological record reveals information about gold and the kingdom of Mapungubwe. Which TWO pieces of information are mentioned by the writer?

- A Not everyone in Mapungubwe used gold as a form of payment.
- B Items of gold were placed close to where Mapungubwe kings were buried.
- C The most valuable item discovered in Mapungubwe was a sceptre made of gold.
- D The way gold was decorated in Mapungubwe was also practised in another kingdom.
- E Working with gold was a respected occupation in the Mapungubwe community.

20 (A / B / C / D / E)

21. The archaeological record reveals information about gold and the kingdom of Mapungubwe. Which TWO pieces of information are mentioned by the writer?

- A Not everyone in Mapungubwe used gold as a form of payment.
- B Items of gold were placed close to where Mapungubwe kings were buried.
- C The most valuable item discovered in Mapungubwe was a sceptre made of gold.
- D The way gold was decorated in Mapungubwe was also practised in another kingdom.

E Working with gold was a respected occupation in the Mapungubwe community.

21 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 22–26

Complete the summary below.

Choose ONE WORD ONLY from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 22–26 on your answer sheet.

Archaeological discoveries

The Mapungubwe community's **22** is indicated by the amount of professionally made pottery discovered at the site. Many of these objects, such as beakers and bowls, are highly decorated and have been marked with stamps. Other finds include round ceramic objects,

23 and figures of various animals, as well as models of people with stretched

24 It is possible that these had a role in ceremonies to honour

25 In addition, pieces of **26** made from a local metal have been found at the site.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE**Artificial Intelligence**

In many countries in the West, hysteria about the future of artificial intelligence (AI) is everywhere. There seems to be no shortage of sensationalist news about how AI could cure diseases, accelerate human innovation and improve human creativity. Just looking at the media headlines, you might think that we are already living in a future where AI has infiltrated every aspect of society.

While it is undeniable that AI has opened up a wealth of promising opportunities, it has also led to the emergence of a mindset that can be best described as 'AI solutionism'. This is the philosophy that, given enough data, machine learning algorithms can solve all of humanity's problems. But, in fact, instead of supporting AI progress, this mindset actually jeopardises the value of machine intelligence by disregarding important AI safety principles and setting unrealistic expectations about what AI can really do for humanity.

In only a few years, AI solutionism has made its way from the technology evangelists' mouths in Silicon Valley in California to the minds of government officials and policymakers around the world. The pendulum has swung from the dystopian notion that AI will destroy humanity to the utopian belief that our algorithmic saviour is here.

We are now seeing governments pledge support to national AI initiatives and compete in a technological race to dominate the burgeoning machine-learning sector. While many politicians proclaim the transformative effects of the coming 'AI revolution', they fail to realise the complexity around deploying advanced machine learning systems in the real world.

One of the most promising varieties of AI technologies are neural networks. This form of machine learning is loosely modelled on the neuronal structure of the human brain, but on a much smaller scale. But what many politicians do not understand is that simply adding a neural network to a problem will not automatically mean that you'll find a solution. Similarly, adding a neural network to a system of government does not mean it will be instantaneously more inclusive or fair.

AI systems need a lot of data to function, but the public sector typically does not have the appropriate data infrastructure to support advanced machine learning. Most of the data remains stored in offline archives. The few digitised sources of data that exist tend to be buried in bureaucracy. More often than not, data is spread across different government departments that each require special permissions to be accessed. Above all, the public sector typically lacks the human talent with the right technological capabilities to fully reap the benefits of machine intelligence.

For these reasons, the sensationalism over AI has attracted many critics. Stuart Russell, a professor of computer science at the University of California, Berkeley, has long advocated a more sensible and realistic approach that focuses on simple everyday applications of AI instead of the hypothetical takeover by super-intelligent robots. Similarly, Rodney Brooks, professor of robotics at Massachusetts Institute of Technology, writes that 'almost all innovations in robotics and AI take far, far, longer to be really widely deployed than people in the field and outside the field imagine'.

One of the many difficulties in deploying machine learning systems is that AI is extremely susceptible to adversarial attacks. This means that a malicious AI can target another AI to make it behave in a certain way, such as forcing it to make wrong predictions. Many researchers have warned against the rolling out of AI without appropriate security standards and defence mechanisms. Still, AI security remains an often overlooked topic when machine learning systems are installed.

If we are to reap the benefits and minimise the potential harms of AI, we must start thinking about how machine learning can be meaningfully applied to specific areas of government, business and society. This means we need to have a discussion about AI ethics and the distrust that many people have towards machine learning.

Most importantly, we need to be aware of the limitations of AI and where people still need to take the lead. Instead of painting an unrealistic picture of the power of AI, it is important to take a step back and separate the actual technological capabilities of AI from fantasy.

The medical profession has also recognised the drawbacks to AI. The IBM Watson for Oncology programme was a piece of AI that was meant to help doctors treat cancer. Even though it was developed to deliver the best recommendations, human experts found it hard to trust the machine. As a result, the AI programme was abandoned in most hospitals where it was trialled.

Similar difficulties arose in the legal domain when algorithms were used in courts in the US to sentence criminals. An algorithm calculated risk assessment scores and advised judges on the sentencing. The system was found to amplify structural racial discrimination and was later abandoned.

There are some crucial lessons here for everyone aiming to boost investments in national AI programmes. These examples demonstrate that there is no AI solution for everything. Using AI simply for the sake of AI may not always be productive or useful, and not every issue is best addressed by applying machine intelligence to it. All solutions come with a cost and not everything that can be automated should be.

Questions 27–29

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**.

27. What is the writer doing in the first paragraph?

- A** predicting the future impact of AI
- B** describing a public perception of AI
- C** outlining some possible benefits of AI
- D** highlighting the breadth of the influence of AI

27 (A / B / C / D)

28. When discussing AI solutionism in the second paragraph, the writer

- A** points out a risk involved.
- B** specifies its probable origins.
- C** mentions its chief supporters.
- D** weighs up some pros and cons.

28 (A / B / C / D)

29. In the fourth paragraph, the writer suggests that many politicians may

- A** have failed to appreciate the true potential of AI initiatives.
- B** have misunderstood the function of the machine-learning sector.
- C** be unaware of the challenges of implementing national AI initiatives.
- D** be too keen to enter the race to dominate the machine-learning sector.

29 (A / B / C / D)

Questions 30–35

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–I**, below.

A	reliability
B	funding
C	skills
D	prejudices
E	computers
F	equality

G	framework
H	confidentiality
I	approval

AI in government, medicine and the law

Neural networks are a promising area of AI technology for governments. However, many politicians overestimate their capabilities, believing that the mere addition of a neural network will produce solutions and promote **30** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I).

Most public sector organisations have not set up the necessary **31** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) to manage the huge amount of data required to enable AI to function. Complex bureaucracy is another issue, as each person involved needs **32** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) to access the relevant data, which is often spread across different departments. But the main problem is that few public sector employees have the **33** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) to take full advantage of machine intelligence.

The medical profession experimented with an AI programme, but their experts had little faith in its **34** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I), and the programme was abandoned. US courts also abandoned the use of algorithms when it was found that these reflected and magnified the existing **35** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I) within the legal profession.

Questions 36-39

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 36-39 on your answer sheet, write

YES if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

36. Stuart Russell's proposals regarding the use of AI are impractical.

36 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

37. Rodney Brooks' view has attracted unfair criticism from supporters of AI.

37 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

38. Nowadays, the need to protect AI systems is always taken into account when they are set up.

38 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

39. In order to benefit from AI and minimise the harms, we have to explore people's concerns about its use. **39** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

Question 40

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

40. What would be a suitable subtitle for Reading Passage 3?

A How to make the most of what AI has to offer

- B** Why AI may not be the answer to our problems
- C** Why governments should not invest in AI systems
- D** How AI could improve the efficiency of the public sector

40 (A / B / C / D)



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/reading/9WwSoeDiDNsG9rjAKht7>

Reading Answer Sheet — Practice Test 2



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

R-9WwSoeDiDNsG9rjAKht7

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20 _____	40 _____

Writing

2 tasks · 60 minutes

TASK 1

COLLEGE CAFE REDESIGN

You should **spend about 20 minutes** on this task.

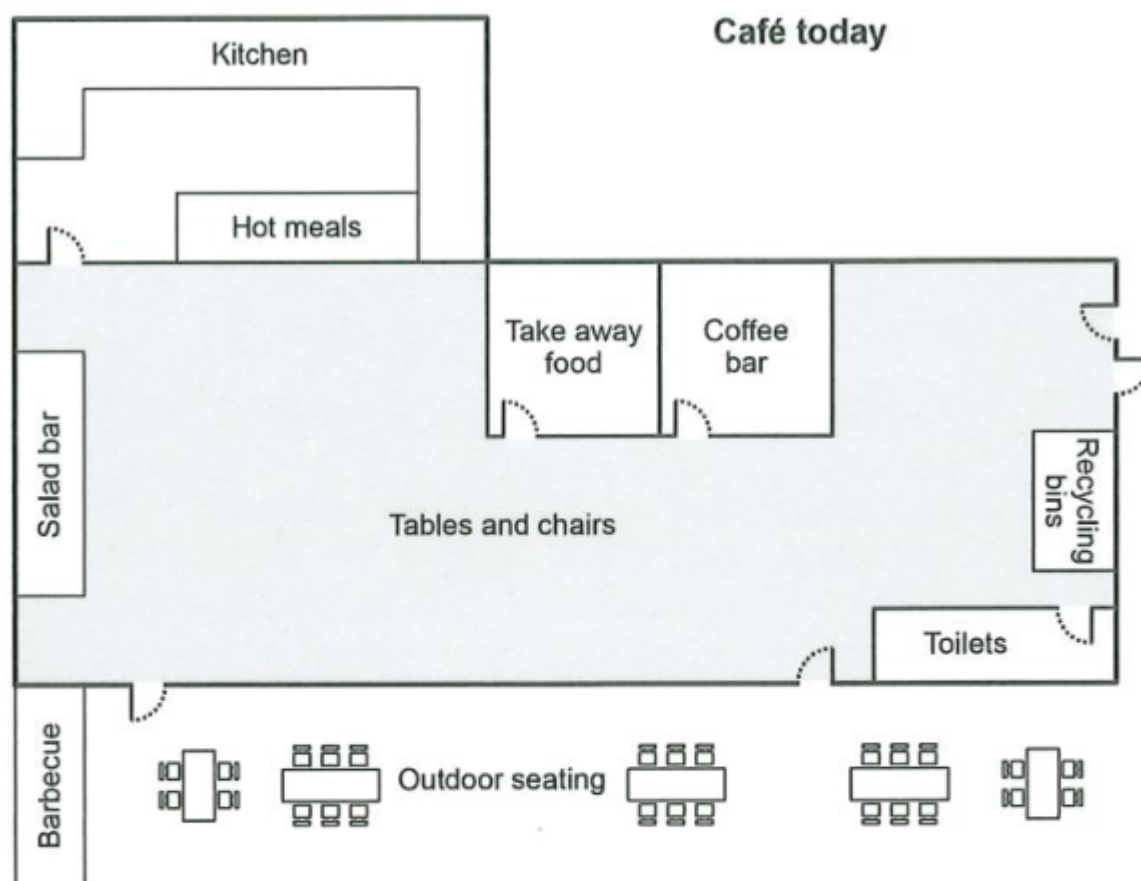
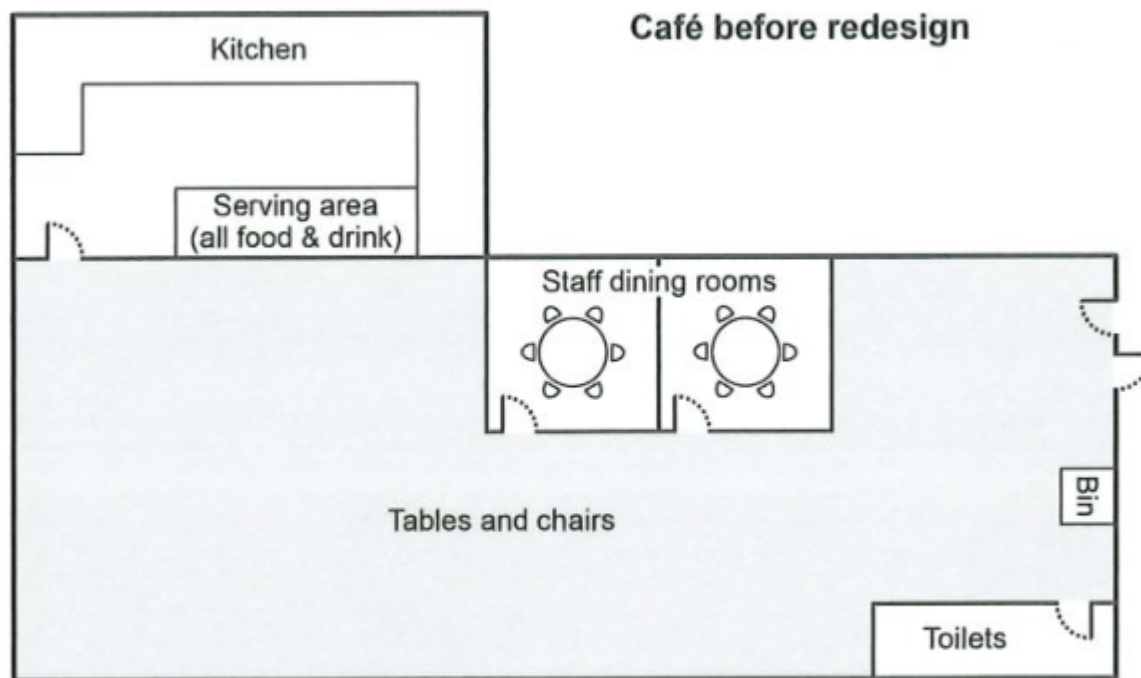
Write at least 150 words.

The plans below show a college cafe before it was redesigned and how it looks now.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

The plans below show a college cafe before it was redesigned and how it looks now.

J words.





Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 1? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 2 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/uj34yDtBOvUaa1901QER?task=T1>



Sheet ID: W-uj34yDtBOvUaa1901QER-T1

TASK 2

IMPORTANCE OF THEATRES AND CINEMAS IN THE DIGITAL AGE

You should **spend about 40 minutes** on this task.

Write at least 250 words.

Some people say that in the digital age, theatres and cinemas are no longer important as people can watch all the entertainment they want online. Others argue that theatres and cinemas are still important both economically and culturally.

Discuss both these views and give your own opinion.

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 2? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 2 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/uj34yDtBOvUaa1901QER?task=T2>



Sheet ID: W-uj34yDtBOvUaa1901QER-T2

Speaking

3 parts · 11–14 minutes · practise aloud, ideally with a partner or recorder

PART 1

CITIES

1. Can you tell me your full name, please?
2. What can I call you?
3. Where are you from?
4. Do you work, or are you a student?
5. How well do you know the capital city of your country?
6. Do you think cities are exciting places to live?
7. Why do some people dislike living in a city?
8. If you could visit any city in the world, where would you go?

PART 2

DESCRIBE A TIME WHEN YOU READ OR HEARD SOMETHING THAT YOU THOUGHT WAS NOT TRUE.

Describe a time when you read or heard something that you thought was not true.

You should say:

- where you read/heard this
- what you read/heard
- why you thought it was not true

and explain how you felt about reading/hearing this thing that you thought was not true.

You have one minute to prepare. Then speak for 1–2 minutes.

PART 3

HONESTY

1. Do you think children are more honest than adults?
2. Why do adults tell children it's important to be honest?
3. Do you think there are sometimes good reasons for adults not to tell children the truth?
4. Are there any claims in advertisements that are sometimes not true?

5. Why do people still buy things even when they know advertisements aren't completely accurate?

6. Do you think advertisements that are dishonest should be banned?



Scan to record & get an AI band score

Practised these questions aloud? Scan to record your answers on your phone and get an instant AI speaking evaluation across all four criteria.

<https://keenielts.com/check/speaking/Tujf7wf8pmnEQQtMZHLH>

CAMBRIDGE IELTS 21

Practice Test 3

Academic · KeenIELTS Offline Practice

Listening

40 questions • approx. 30 minutes + 10 minutes transfer time



Scan to play the test audio

Point your phone camera at the code — the audio opens directly in your browser, no login required. Play it once only, just like the real exam.

<https://keenielts.com/listening-audio/fzNRVhDXQCbvDUQtTNuT>

- Answer all the questions as you listen — the recording is played **once** only.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then transfer them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

SECTION 1

Questions 1-10

Complete the notes below.

Write **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

Ferry to Shetland Islands

- **Name of ferry company:** 1 Ferries
- **Ferries depart seven times per:** 2 in summer
- **Cost for four people with car:** a little less than £ 3
- **Cancellation policy:** receive a 4 (if cancelled a month in advance)

Advice

- **Cabins:**
 - book one with a 5
 - luxury cabins have a TV
- **Bring snacks and** 6 for the children
- **A** 7 is required for the dog kennels
- **Try to see** 8 in the morning
- **If time, visit** 9 Castle
- **The** 10 restaurant in a nearby village is recommended

SECTION 2**SECTION 2****Questions 11-12**

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.

A	low price
B	locally sourced
C	freshly made
D	convenience
E	unusual food

11. Which **TWO** explanations for the popularity of street food are given?

11 (A / B / C / D / E)

12. Which **TWO** explanations for the popularity of street food are given?

12 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 13-14

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.

A	music festivals
B	food markets
C	weddings
D	parties
E	parks

13. Which **TWO** places are recommended for new street food businesses?

13 (A / B / C / D / E)

14. Which **TWO** places are recommended for new street food businesses?

14 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 15-16

Choose the correct letter, **A, B** or **C**.

15. What does the speaker say about getting equipment for a street food business?

A High quality equipment is a good investment.

B It's best to buy second-hand equipment.

C Renting equipment can be cheap.

15 (A / B / C)

16. What advice is given about creating a product for a street food business?

A Provide information about the ingredients.

B It is important to have an original product.

C The presentation is an important factor.

16 (A / B / C)

Questions 17-20

What problem did the owners of each of the following street food businesses experience?

Choose FOUR answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-F, next to Questions 17-20.

Problems

A	Some ingredients were too expensive.
B	The meals took a long time to prepare.
C	They had no money for marketing.
D	It was difficult to get a permit to sell food.
E	A competitor was selling similar food in their area.
F	They worked very long hours.

17. Thai Basil **17** (A / B / C / D / E / F)

18. Basque **18** (A / B / C / D / E / F)

19. Lou's kitchen **19** (A / B / C / D / E / F)

20. Chip Chop **20** (A / B / C / D / E / F)

SECTION 3

SECTION 3

Questions 21-22

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

A	Their definitions keep changing.
----------	----------------------------------

B	People think they mean the same thing.
C	The term 'eco-friendly' is preferable.
D	They are often used imprecisely.
E	Companies should avoid using them on clothing labels.

21. Which TWO points do the speakers make about the terms 'ethical' and 'sustainable' fashion?

21 (A / B / C / D / E)

22. Which TWO points do the speakers make about the terms 'ethical' and 'sustainable' fashion?

22 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 23-24

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

Which TWO claims about wool production do the speakers disagree with?

A	Sheep are generally well-treated.
B	Wool is easy to recycle.
C	Wool is a long-lasting fabric.
D	Wool production involves few chemicals.
E	Sheep do less environmental damage than other livestock.

23. Which TWO claims about wool production do the speakers disagree with?

23 (A / B / C / D / E)

24. Which TWO claims about wool production do the speakers disagree with?

24 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 25-30

What comment do the speakers make about each of the following semi-synthetic fabrics?

Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 25-30.

A	The production process is fuel efficient.
B	It is the least sustainable of alternative fabrics.
C	Production costs are high.

D	It provides additional health benefits.
E	It is not durable in the long-term.
F	It needs to be produced in a certain way to be sustainable.
G	Chemicals required for production can be reused.
H	This is from a wholly sustainable source.

25. Lyocell **25** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
26. Cupro **26** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
27. Bamboo **27** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
28. EcoVero **28** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
29. Cork **29** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)
30. Hemp **30** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H)

SECTION 4

SECTION 4

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below.

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

Invasive species

Definition: an animal or plant that causes harm to an environment after being introduced by humans

An invasive species can be a problem when it:

- eats native species.
- introduces a new **31**
- takes food from native species.
- threatens an entire **32**

How invasive species spread

- accidentally e.g. via people returning from their **33**or on cargo ships
- intentionally e.g. for pest control, or as **34**

Examples of invasive species

- *Rhinella marina* (toads)
 - were introduced to Australia from Hawaii in 1935 to eat a type of insect that was damaging the **35** plantations.
 - failed to solve the problem and became widespread in the north of Australia.
 - are poisonous for any species that eats them and reduce the food available for native frogs.
- Japanese knotweed plants were popular among 19th-century gardeners in the UK.
- *Rhododendron* plants prevent **36** from reaching native plants.
- Grey squirrels from N. America reduce sources of food for the UK's native red squirrels and spread a **37** that kills red squirrels.

Tackling invasive species

- Monitoring helps us to understand the **38** of invasive species and the impact they have.
- Setting up a national **39** makes it easier to track them.
- Asking the public to **40** and report them helps with monitoring.



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/listening/fzNRVhDXQCbvdUQtTNuT>

Listening Answer Sheet — Practice Test 3



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

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12	_____	32	_____
13	_____	33	_____
14	_____	34	_____
15	_____	35	_____
16	_____	36	_____
17	_____	37	_____
18	_____	38	_____
19	_____	39	_____
20	_____	40	_____

Reading

40 questions · 60 minutes

- Read each passage and answer the questions that follow. No extra time is given to transfer answers.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then copy them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

SAVING THE SAIGA

Saving the saiga

The saiga, a species of antelope native to Central Asia, once roamed the vast grasslands of this region in enormous herds, many millions strong. Regrettably, such spectacular sights are a thing of the past. Today, the saiga is largely confined to a single country: Kazakhstan. This country is estimated to be home to well over 90% of the global saiga population, with Russia, Mongolia and Uzbekistan accounting for the rest.

The saiga is perfectly adapted to the tough conditions of the remote wilderness of the steppes of Central Asia. One such adaptation is its bizarre bulbous nose, which enables the animal to survive the extreme seasonal temperature swings of the region. The swollen nostrils of the nose serve several purposes: they filter out dust and cool the blood during hot, dry summers, and they warm the cold air before it enters the saiga's lungs in winter. Other seasonal adaptations include a heavy winter coat that the saiga sheds when the weather warms up.

Despite these superb adaptations to harsh conditions, the saiga has no defence against the threats posed by humans. It was almost driven to extinction by hunters in the 19th century. Legal protection ensured its survival for a while, and numbers steadily recovered throughout most of the 20th century. But the respite was only temporary. In the ten years following the break-up of the former Soviet Union in 1991, over 95% of the global population was lost - one of the fastest examples of species loss ever recorded for a mammal.

The dramatic decline during this decade was due to illegal poaching on an industrial scale. Male saiga are a particular target, because their horns are highly prized by traditional medicine practitioners. Poaching reached epidemic levels after misguided conservationists tried to relieve the pressure on threatened African rhinos by actively encouraging the use of saiga horns in traditional medicine as an alternative to those of rhinos. Male saiga were almost wiped out, leading to a population crash from which the species has been struggling to recover ever since.

Another threat to the survival of the saiga is loss of habitat, as a result of agricultural expansion and human settlement. Physical barriers such as railways, pipelines and fences can block the seasonal migration routes of this transboundary species. In the worst cases, herds may starve to death after being trapped.

Then there is the risk of disease. In 2015, an outbreak of haemorrhagic septicaemia, caused by the normally harmless bacterium *Pasteurella multocida*, killed over 75% of the global adult saiga population in just three weeks. In 2017, 60% of the Mongolian saiga population - a subspecies found nowhere else in the world - was killed by a virus that spilled over from livestock. These so-called mass mortality events represent an unpredictable and serious threat to the species.

Climate change poses a further threat. Although well adapted to cold winters and hot summers, saiga struggle to cope with temperature extremes and unpredictable fluctuations in climate. Experts believe that unusually warm weather may have triggered the 2015 mass mortality event. The steppe region has also become increasingly arid in recent years, and many of the smaller streams that the species normally depended on have dried up and vanished.

Recent efforts to save the saiga have been spearheaded by the Altyn Dala Conservation Initiative, a project led by the Association for the Conservation of Biodiversity of Kazakhstan, working in partnership with the Kazakh government's Committee for Forestry and Wildlife, Frankfurt Zoological Society and Fauna and Flora, an international conservation charity. Its purpose is to protect and restore Kazakhstan's steppe, semi-desert and desert ecosystems and the many species they support, including the critically endangered saiga. In 2022 the United Nations recognised the initiative as a World Restoration Flagship project, an accolade reserved for the ten best examples of large-scale ecosystem restoration around the globe.

So, how many saiga are there now? By 2000, the global saiga population had hit an all time low of just 21,000 individuals. There was some recovery in the first decade of the new millennium but this was then crushed by devastating mass mortality events that saw the loss of hundreds of thousands of the species. But thanks to the intervention of the Altyn Dala Conservation Initiative, the most recent episodes in the ongoing story of the saiga have been relatively uplifting. Three years ago, the Ustyurt Plateau population in Kazakhstan experienced its largest mass birth of saiga calves in many years. An aerial census two years ago recorded an estimated 842,000 saiga across Kazakhstan as a whole, and according to an aerial survey earlier this year, the saiga population in Kazakhstan now exceeds 1.9 million. The world's strangest-looking antelope remains critically endangered, but the direction of travel is positive.

Questions 1-7

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 1-7 on your answer sheet.

The saiga
Adaptations
• has a large bulbous nose with swollen nostrils that
- keep 1 out
- lower the temperature of its 2 in summer
- warm the air entering its lungs in winter
• grows a thick 3 in winter, which it loses in spring
Reasons for population decline
• poaching, especially for the 4 of male saiga
• expansion of farms and settlements, causing
- reduction in the size of the saiga's 5
- loss of access to the 6 which they use for migration
• various forms of disease, leading to mass mortality events
• climate change, causing the disappearance of 7 which the saiga relied on

Questions 8-13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 8-13 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 8.** Today, numbers of saiga are distributed evenly across four nations in Central Asia: Kazakhstan, Russia, Mongolia and Uzbekistan. **8** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
- 9.** For most of the 20th century, the population of saiga were falling.
9 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
- 10.** Efforts to protect rhinos in Africa had a significant effect on saiga populations.
10 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
- 11.** Unpredictable fluctuations in climate are threatening the wildlife of Central Asia more than in other parts of the world. **11** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
- 12.** The Altyn Dala Conservation Initiative was formed for the benefit of a number of different animals. **12** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)
- 13.** The Altyn Dala Conservation Initiative's recognition as a World Restoration Flagship project attracted additional international funding for the scheme. **13** (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

THE PROBLEMS OF GETTING AROUND THE CITY OF DAR ES SALAAM

The problems of getting around the city of Dar es Salaam

Dar es Salaam in Tanzania is one of the fastest growing cities in Africa. Its population has increased eightfold since 1980 and swells by half a million people every year. United Nations projections anticipate it will become a megacity within seven years as its population passes 10 million, reaching 13.4 million by 2035. Daniel Hoornweg for the Global Cities Institute forecasts the city could be home to an incredible 73.7 million people by 2100.

Today, four out of five of its people live in single-storey informal settlements on the spreading edges of the city, where the journey to and from the centre regularly takes over two hours. It can be longer if rain turns the dirt roads to mud.

Even in the middle of the day, traffic frequently slows to a stop without warning. It is not unusual for cars and minibuses to queue for 20 minutes at a key intersection. A single suburban rail line serves residents in a few areas to the south but is tiny in the context of the wider city. Outside the centre many rely on boda boda (motorbike taxis) to navigate the narrow side streets and potholed mud roads that make up much of the metropolis. Their safety record is scandalous.

Dar es Salaam's reliance on four arterial roads into the city is a legacy of the colonial government that planned the city at the start of the 20th century to cater for a population of 35,000. Most of the current growth is made up of young people arriving from the countryside to find work, and as the population has exploded, Dar es Salaam has grown around those four highways. Nearly all the expansion is happening on the periphery, and nearly all takes place informally without any agreed strategy.

But Dar es Salaam is pinning its hopes on a solution that could offer a different model for Africa's megacities, giving them an alternative to a future controlled by the private car. Unlike many cities on the continent, Dares Salaam isn't trying to build a metro. It has chosen a less exciting but cheaper and more achievable method: the bus.

The DART bus rapid transit (BRT) system runs on bus lanes separated from other traffic, mostly in the middle of the road to reduce stoppages. Ticket purchase and control takes place at stations prior to boarding and the buses are step-free, which means the entire route is accessible to people using wheelchairs or who are travelling with baby buggies.

'The new buses are much, much better,' says Paulas George, a young IT worker. He takes the bus every day and it has cut his journey time by two-thirds. He says it is not perfect, though, complaining that drivers often refuse to turn on the air conditioning to save fuel.

That is not the only problem. A shortage of buses after a serious flood at the main depot during the rainy season means the system is carrying 200,000 people a day - half the expected capacity. Smartcards can't be used as the mechanical readers aren't working either, forcing passengers to buy individual paper tickets for every journey. Each is printed with a scannable QR code, but there are no scanners. Staff stand by the gates and tear tickets as people enter. As a result, queues are considerable at peak times.

Morogoro Road to the north-west of the city was phase I of the BRT project. Phases II and III will install bus lanes along Nyerere Road to the south-west and Kilwa Road to the south. Construction on both routes is due to start imminently. Phase IV, towards Bagamoyo in the north, is in the preliminary design stage. 'Much of the city will have access to a world-class transport system within the space of a few years,' says Chris Kost, the Africa director of ITDP (the Institute for Transportation and Development Policy). All phases

are being planned to high standards and, once complete, a third of city residents will be within a short walk of the BRT network.

The ITDP regrets Africa's obsession with metros. 'With a metro, an international firm will often just parachute in its own system,' says Kost. 'Bus rapid transit allows existing stakeholders to get involved. That's what we did in Dares Salaam and what we're planning in Nairobi, where the bus bodies will be built in the city and local operators will look after tickets, fare collection and IT ... Bus rapid transit has been transformational for Dares Salaam. For millions of people in African cities, this is their best hope of ever being connected.'

Questions 14-18

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

In boxes 14-18 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

14. The population of Dar es Salaam is rising more rapidly than was previously predicted.

14 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

15. Most of the residents of Dares Salaam live in high-rise blocks on the edge of the city.

15 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

16. Residents have been consulted about their views on the suburban rail line in Dares Salaam.

16 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

17. The majority of the present residential development in Dar es Salaam is unplanned.

17 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

18. Dares Salaam's authorities have decided to follow the public transport plan adopted by a large number of African cities. 18 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

Questions 19-26

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 19-26 on your answer sheet.

Dar es Salaam's DART Bus Rapid Transit system

Features

- the buses use designated 19 to cut down on delays
- passengers pay fares before 20
- passengers in 21 can use every part of the system

Problems

- the temperature control is sometimes not activated in order to reduce 22use
- insufficient number of vehicles are available due to the effects of a severe 23
- passengers are unable to use 24 because some equipment is out of action
- tickets have to be checked manually at station 25

- **26** frequently build up during rush hours

RETHINKING THE PAST

Rethinking the Past

It is by now a truism that the story of human evolution is being rethought. Discoveries have come thick and fast over the last decade or so, and these have forced us to rethink many crucial points, such as how old our species is - about 300,000 years old as opposed to 200,000 - and what extinct hominins, such as our cousins the Neanderthals, were really like. But because there are so many species and eras involved, it's hard to discern the common threads linking them.

However, I do think it's possible to draw out some overall messages from the blizzard of archaeological finds in recent years. Two things stand out to me. One is the growing evidence that many supposedly 'advanced' behaviours, such as architecture and art, can be traced much further back in time than we thought, often to hominin species that existed before modern humans. And the other is that we have badly misunderstood gender roles in prehistoric societies, imposing patriarchal values onto cultures that had very different ideas about how women should behave.

Let's start with architecture. At Kalambo Falls in Zambia, researchers found buried logs that had been shaped with stone tools so that they interlocked. They seem to have once been part of a larger structure, perhaps a building. This would be unsurprising if they weren't 476,000 years old. That's almost 200,000 years before our species, *Homo sapiens*, evolved. Extinct hominins also managed to settle in extreme places. For instance, we now know that extinct hominins such as the Denisovans lived on the frozen heights of high-altitude regions 200,000 years ago - upending the old notion that such environments were only settled by modern humans around 3,600 years ago.

Art also seems to have been invented by older hominins. We have had evidence for a long time now that Neanderthals painted on cave walls. Even earlier species, such as *Homo erectus*, may also have made art, for example by engraving patterns on shells.

By far the most contentious claim in this area is that *Homo naledi* made art. *H. naledi* lived around 250,000 years ago, making it a contemporary of our species. However, it had quite a small brain, typical of older hominins - and was therefore, according to palaeoanthropological dogma, incapable of complex behaviours. Nevertheless, in the Rising Star cave system in South Africa where the *H. naledi* remains were found, researchers have found what seem to be etchings - resembling rudimentary artwork - on the cave walls, though these have yet to be firmly dated.

To say these claims about *H. naledi* are controversial is to understate the situation. Many experts say the evidence presented so far is completely inadequate to support them. The dispute has only been heightened by the way the results were released, in a non-traditional journal that publishes peer reviews publicly alongside the paper. My views on the *H. naledi* controversy are complicated. I do think more evidence is needed: in particular with regard to the dating of the etchings. At the same time, I think the species' small brains are a distraction. Palaeoanthropologists got fixated on brain size because it was what they could see: if what you have is skeletons, then all you know about brains are their shapes and sizes. But other properties, such as the brain's internal wiring, are surely equally important and may explain how a species like *H. naledi* might have been capable of complex behaviours, despite their small brains.

In a sense, we shouldn't be surprised that so many of these behaviours had their origins in older, extinct hominins. Evolution usually works by incremental steps and so does technology. The first birds weren't great at flying, and the first mobile phones weren't great at, well, anything really. The idea that there was a sudden explosion of intelligence and creativity at some point in our evolution isn't inherently ridiculous:

sometimes a system hits a tipping point and undergoes runaway change. But there was never that much evidence that human evolution worked this way. Instead, it seems the Neanderthals and many others all walked so we could run.

One way or another, the *H. naledi* story is going to be an example of letting our preconceptions get in the way of the evidence. The same is true for our ideas about gender in prehistory. Archaeology was invented by individuals with now unfashionably patriarchal views about gender, and those notions fed into their research. Today's researchers are trying to unpick this stuff, and there have been some significant steps in recent years.

Perhaps the most dramatic was the demolition of 'Man the Hunter'. This was the idea, promoted for decades, that in most prehistoric societies the men went out to hunt and the women looked after the home. However, a meta-analysis published in June 2023 compiled data on several dozen foraging societies and found women hunted in 80 per cent of them. In line with this, it emerged that an ancient spear-throwing tool called an atlatl enables women to launch projectiles at the same speed as men. We have also seen growing evidence of women occupying positions of authority in ancient societies. The Viking queen Thyra may have helped unify Denmark in the 900s. Going further back, an Iberian leader from around 4000 years ago turned out to be female, not male as many had assumed, when proteins in her teeth were analysed.

It seems that the more we find out about past societies, the more our preconceptions about the ways society 'has to be' turn out to be wrong. Inequality, authoritarianism and patriarchy aren't inevitable. They're choices, and prehistory shows us that we can choose differently.

Questions 27-30

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C or D**.

Write the correct letter in boxes **27-30** on your answer sheet.

27. What is the writer doing in the second paragraph?

- A** pinpointing some key changes in our understanding of prehistory
- B** outlining some aspects of prehistory which are still poorly understood
- C** summarising some attitudes towards recent archaeological revelations
- D** giving an overview of some current disagreements among archaeologists

27 (A / B / C / D)

28. In the sixth paragraph, the writer mentions mobile phones to make the point that

- A** most developments happen in a gradual way.
- B** innovation can come from a variety of sources.
- C** not all technological advancements are positive.
- D** the path of evolution can often be unpredictable.

28 (A / B / C / D)

29. In the seventh paragraph, the phrase 'unpick this stuff' refers to the task of

- A** assessing the impact of certain recent research findings.
- B** questioning the authenticity of evidence used in earlier research.
- C** conducting research into how prehistoric societies were organised.
- D** reevaluating research influenced by outdated beliefs about society.

29 (A / B / C / D)

30. What does the writer suggest in the final paragraph?

- A** Studying past societies could help us create a fairer society today.
- B** We should not judge past societies by the standards of modern society.
- C** We still have much to learn about how societies have evolved over history.
- D** There is more than one way to interpret evidence about societies in prehistoric times.

30 (A / B / C / D)

Questions 31-34

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A-F**, below.

Write the correct letter, **A-F**, in boxes **31-34** on your answer sheet.

A	Homo sapiens emerged at an earlier point in time than experts previously believed.
B	previous assumptions about who had power in the prehistoric world were inaccurate.
C	gender roles in extinct hominin species were different from those in Homo sapiens societies.
D	experts may have been mistaken about who looked for food in early human communities.
E	Homo sapiens was probably not the only species capable of sophisticated workmanship.
F	other species managed to survive in harsh environments before the arrival of Homo sapiens.

31. The findings at Kalambo Falls revealed that **31** (A / B / C / D / E / F)
32. Evidence from high-altitude regions suggests that **32** (A / B / C / D / E / F)
33. An academic publication from June 2023 shows that **33** (A / B / C / D / E / F)
34. Analysis of a 4000-year-old Iberian leader indicates that **34** (A / B / C / D / E / F)

Questions 35–40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 35–40 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the views of the writer

NO — if the statement contradicts the views of the writer

NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

35. It seems likely that the Neanderthals' cave paintings were the first examples of artwork ever created. **35** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

36. It is very rare to find prehistoric artwork carved onto shells.

36 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

37. The methods which the researchers used to examine the Rising Star cave system were rather unconventional. **37** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

38. It is unclear how old the etchings in the Rising Star cave system are.

38 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

39. The means used to publicise the findings from the Rising Star cave system added to the controversy that surrounds them. **39** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

40. The size of H. naledi brains is a key factor in the question of whether these hominins were able to produce art. **40** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/reading/FPsNQkj2DPior57C8Hje>

Reading Answer Sheet — Practice Test 3



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

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17	_____	37	_____
18	_____	38	_____
19	_____	39	_____
20	_____	40	_____

Writing

2 tasks · 60 minutes

TASK 1

THE FORMATION OF RAIN-SHADOW DESERTS

You should **spend about 20 minutes** on this task.

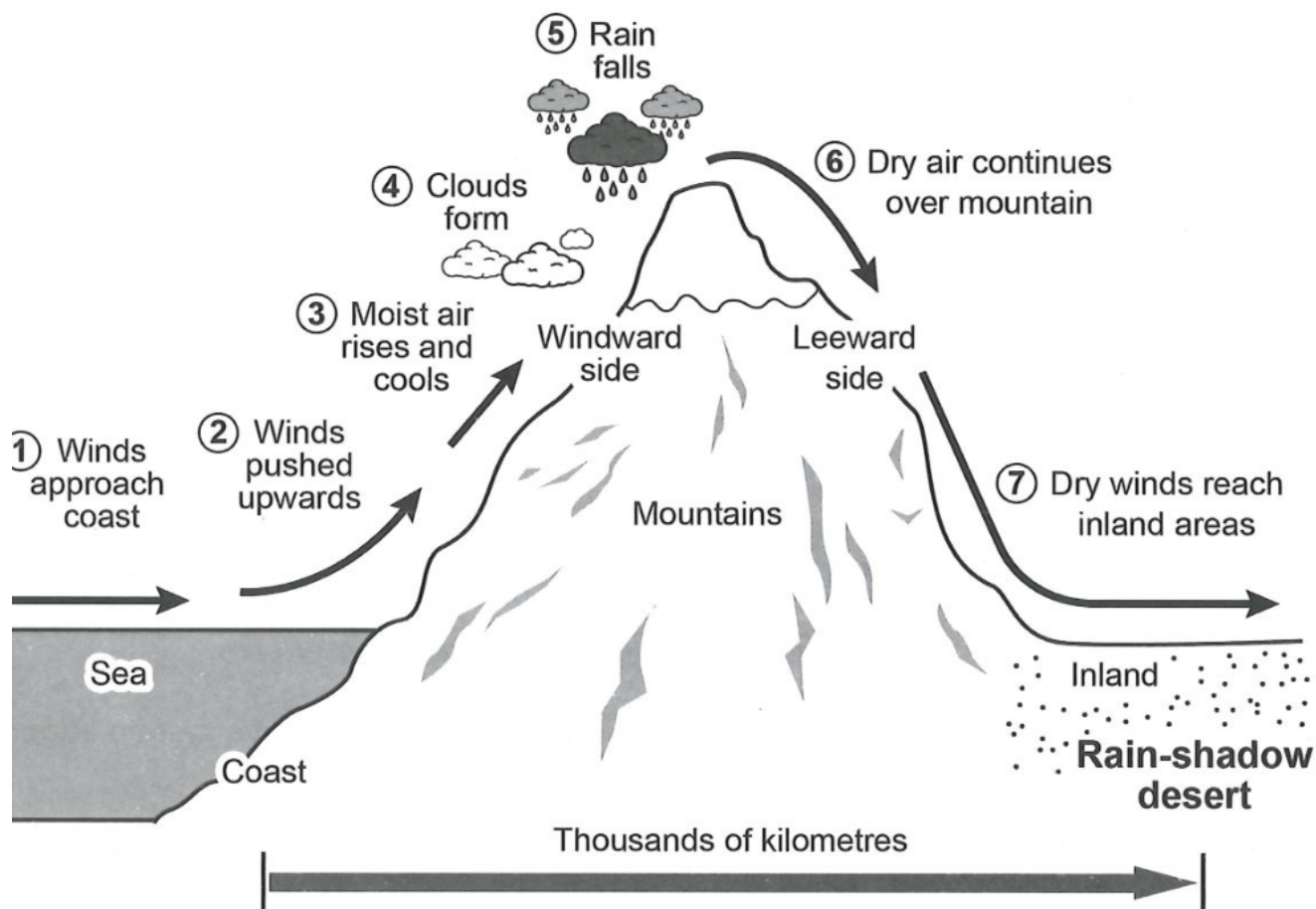
Write at least 150 words.

The diagram below shows how one type of desert, known as a rain-shadow desert, is formed.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

The formation of rain-shadow deserts

The formation of rain-shadow deserts



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 1? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 3 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/1xzfrj6zgllgBRUSf?task=T1>



Sheet ID: W-1xzfrj6zgllgBRUShUsf-T1

TASK 2

UNIVERSITY STUDY ABROAD OR WORK PLACEMENT

You should **spend about 40 minutes** on this task.

Write at least 250 words.

All university undergraduate courses should include a period of time spent studying abroad or doing a work placement.

Do you think the advantages of this would outweigh the disadvantages?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 2? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 3 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/1xzfrj6zgllgBRUShUsf?task=T2>



Sheet ID: W-1xzfrj6zgllgBRUShUsf-T2

Speaking

3 parts · 11–14 minutes · practise aloud, ideally with a partner or recorder

PART 1

SPENDING AND SAVING MONEY

1. Can you tell me your full name, please?
2. What can I call you?
3. Where are you from?
4. Do you work, or are you a student?
5. When you go shopping, do you usually pay for things by cash or by card?
6. Are you generally careful about how much money you spend?
7. Have you ever spent money on something you didn't need?
8. How important is it to you to save money for the future?

PART 2

AN INTERESTING GARDEN OR PARK

Describe an interesting garden or park you have seen.

You should say:

- where this garden or park is
- how big it is
- what you saw in this garden/park

and explain why you think this garden/park is interesting.

You have one minute to prepare. Then speak for 1–2 minutes.

PART 3

HOMES, GARDENS AND GARDENING

1. What are the advantages of having a home with a garden?
2. How could people living in apartment blocks grow plants and vegetables?
3. How interested are people in your country in TV shows and magazines about gardens?
4. Do you think that gardening is a hobby mainly for older people?
5. What are the benefits for people of gardening as a hobby?
6. Will gardening be a more popular hobby in the future?



Scan to record & get an AI band score

Practised these questions aloud? Scan to record your answers on your phone and get an instant AI speaking evaluation across all four criteria.

<https://keenielts.com/check/speaking/DDF6ygHRdBz8jvUGChGm>

CAMBRIDGE IELTS 21

Practice Test 4

Academic · KeenIELTS Offline Practice

Listening

40 questions • approx. 30 minutes + 10 minutes transfer time



Scan to play the test audio

Point your phone camera at the code — the audio opens directly in your browser, no login required. Play it once only, just like the real exam.

<https://keenielts.com/listening-audio/MLkb1DEoG2oWVO2IguGD>

- Answer all the questions as you listen — the recording is played **once** only.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then transfer them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

SECTION 1

Questions 1-10

Complete the form below.

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

Survey about shopping in Broadbeach

Name:	Martyn 1
Today's journey to Broadbeach town centre:	used his 2
Purpose of today's trip:	has visited the 3
	looking for a new 4
	collecting 5 (after repair)
Preferred day for shopping:	6
Opinions about shopping in the town centre	
	Finds the service in shops is excellent
	Thinks there are too many places selling 7
	Would like more places to buy 8

Opinions about new out-of-town Shopping Centre	
	Likes the 9 best Believes the 10 is unnecessary

SECTION 2

SECTION 2

Questions 11-12

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.

A	the Digital Marketing Centre
B	the TalkCon Zone
C	the Breakout area
D	the Business Village
E	the Business Connections Zone

11. In which **TWO** areas of the business exhibition did James Craig promote his company last year?

11 (A / B / C / D / E)

12. In which **TWO** areas of the business exhibition did James Craig promote his company last year?

12 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 13-14

Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.

A	They are available to all members of exhibiting companies.
B	They can be used for both food and clothing.
C	They only apply if people spend at least £400.
D	They can be used by family members.
E	The percentage saved is always the same.

13. Which **TWO** facts are given about discounts on popular brands available to exhibitors?

13 (A / B / C / D / E)

14. Which TWO facts are given about discounts on popular brands available to exhibitors?

14 (A / B / C / D / E)

Questions 15-20

Which topic will each of the following speakers focus on?

Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-G, next to

Questions 15-20.

Topics

A	Supporting job seekers
B	Dealing with personal problems
C	Effects of an unexpectedly rapid expansion
D	A global range of business experiences
E	Coping with financial set-backs
F	Developing a company in response to changing markets
G	Combining business success with contributions to charities

Speakers

15. Jim Clowrie 15 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

16. David France 16 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

17. Oliver Stanton 17 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

18. Francesca Heptonstall 18 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

19. Salman Khan 19 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

20. Annie Craven 20 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G)

SECTION 3

SECTION 3

Questions 21-23

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

Presentation on houses of the future

21. Which aspect of their presentation are Mia and Leo both concerned about?

- A** meeting the deadline
- B** finding suitable examples
- C** including original ideas

21 (A / B / C)

22. The students decide to focus their assignment on housing for

- A** family groups.
- B** old people.
- C** single people.

22 (A / B / C)

23. The students agree that demand for accommodation in urban areas should be met by

- A** repurposing offices and factories.
- B** constructing tall buildings.
- C** developing creative ideas for smaller homes.

23 (A / B / C)

Questions 24-30

What opinion is given about each of the following developments?

Choose SEVEN answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-I, next to Questions 24-30.

Opinions

A	This could cause unnecessary anxiety.
B	This would be especially beneficial for city residents.
C	This would be challenging for young people.
D	This would have environmental benefits.
E	This could encourage creativity.
F	This could lead to social problems.
G	This could enable retired people to share a project.
H	This would help some people but cause problems for others.

I	This would suit both existing and new members of a household.
---	---

Developments

24. use of roof space for gardens **24** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)
25. shared working spaces **25** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)
26. moveable internal walls **26** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)
27. smart mirrors in bathrooms **27** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)
28. bike sheds with charging points **28** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)
29. restriction of cars to certain areas **29** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)
30. communal vegetable plots **30** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I)

SECTION 4

SECTION 4

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below.

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

Music therapy for surgical patients

Background

- Surgery impacts patients because they may experience discomfort or unwelcome changes to their **31**
- Current post-surgical strategies focus mainly on pain relief.

Recent research

- A study reviewed data from about 100 **32** and found that listening to music
 - improved hospital patients' sense of wellbeing.
 - reduced the length of their stay.
- The patients in the study all listened to music with a **33** effect.
- The music was mostly played through music **34**
- Patients reported an absence or low levels of **35**
- Medical records confirmed that patients who were played music in hospital needed less **36** than those who weren't played music.
- The best results were achieved when patients were played music while they were **37**

- The study concluded that playing music was effective because it served as a **38**
- The researchers recommend playing either music or sounds from **39** to all surgical patients.
- A future study will investigate the best **40** for the music.



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/listening/MLkb1DEoG2oWVO2IguGD>

Listening Answer Sheet — Practice Test 4



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

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16	_____	36	_____
17	_____	37	_____
18	_____	38	_____
19	_____	39	_____
20	_____	40	_____

Reading

40 questions • 60 minutes

- Read each passage and answer the questions that follow. No extra time is given to transfer answers.
- Write your answers on the dotted lines, then copy them to the answer sheet at the end of this test.

SECTION 1

THE PROBLEMS AND BENEFITS CREATED BY THE SPREAD OF THE WATER HYACINTH IN KENYA

The problems and benefits created by the spread of the water hyacinth in Kenya

Water hyacinth (*Eichhornia crassipes*), an aquatic plant native to South America, first appeared in countries in Africa in the early 1900s. Scientists there called it the 'world's worst aquatic weed', after it spread from the southernmost tip of Africa in the early 1900s and started obstructing major dams and rivers.

In east Africa the plant arrived with Belgian colonists in Rwanda, who liked the look of its glossy leaves and delicate purple flowers floating in their ponds. But by the 1980s, it had 'escaped' out of the country via the Kagera river and made its way downstream to Lake Victoria. There, with no natural predators and perfect temperature conditions, the plant began spreading in the open water, blocking fishing routes and providing a new habitat for disease-carrying mosquitoes.

For the women who smoke fish from the lake to sell it has meant declining income, as the boats that once brought the fish to shore by the hundreds struggle to navigate through the mass of plants. But water hyacinth isn't their only headache. In order to smoke the fish that they buy, they must gather huge quantities of firewood, sometimes walking as far as 10km each way to collect enough to complete their work. And each day as they cook, they breathe in the thick, grey smoke. About three out of four families in Kenya depend on wood or charcoal to cook their daily meals, and the rate is even higher in rural areas, Kenya's latest demographic and health survey shows.

Using solid fuels like these for cooking increases indoor pollution. The World Health Organization estimates that about 14,300 Kenyans die annually as a result of indoor air pollution - most of which is caused by cooking and heating sources.

Some years ago, on the shores of Lake Victoria, huge piles of water hyacinth that villagers had taken out of the water in an attempt to clear it were a common sight. But buried in those decaying waxy leaves was a renewable energy gold mine. It turns out the floating plant isn't just good at spreading - its foliage also contains a high ratio of carbon to nitrogen. It's a magic combination that has captivated researchers' imaginations since as early as the 1980s when, across the world, they began to explore its potential as a biofuel. Just about 4kg of the dried plant would be enough to cater for a large family's daily energy needs, early research predicted.

In 2014, Nigerian academics announced they had got better yields of biofuel gas when they mixed the plant with chicken manure. A few years later, Kenyan scientists confirmed what their Nigerian peers and others had already found: manure worked to improve the process of converting the weed into gas.

In 2018, the technology came to a village on the shore of Lake Victoria, called Dunga. The project promised a two-for-one solution to the dual menaces of the water hyacinth and dependence on firewood. The community received a pair of donated biogas digesters - machines that would transform a mix of water hyacinth and cow dung into biogas for cooking.

The digesters work a bit like a stomach. The mixture goes in one end - think of it as a mouth - and over the next 20 to 30 days, it goes through a fermentation process and breaks down, giving off gas that comes out the other end. From there, the clean-burning gas is passed through pipes to the point of use, just like traditional domestic gas. In Dunga, the machines produce enough gas to serve about 60% of the village's population. It is used in domestic stoves and for other household tasks such as purifying water and incubating chicks.

The project is testing whether biogas can provide an effective alternative to firewood and charcoal in rural Kenyan communities. Results indicate that the programme seems to be working. The women who smoke the lake fish are already getting sick less often. Besides, they don't have to devote a lot of time every day to gathering firewood, which is a great relief. As a result, they're able to make more money for their families from other enterprises.

Kanyiva Muindi is an epidemiologist and air pollution research fellow at the African Population and Health Research Centre in Nairobi. She says families who switch to the smokeless cooking method could expect fewer respiratory diseases. Women, young girls and children are particularly vulnerable because they are the ones who cook in the kitchen or outside over fires.

How much better the biogas stoves will be for the community's health still needs more research, says Dominic Kahumbu Wanjihia, Biogas International's chief executive. But unless the price of the machines drops, it's pretty clear that most communities will never be able to afford any, since they sell for about \$750.

Kanyiva says affordability is a challenge worth addressing, given the huge health and environmental dangers posed by 'dirty' fuels such as wood, charcoal and kerosene. If biogas could become affordable on a large scale, she says it 'would be life-changing for millions on the African continent and beyond'.

Questions 1-7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 1-7 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

1. Water hyacinth was introduced as a decorative plant in east Africa.

1 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

2. Fishermen took some water hyacinth plants to Lake Victoria.

2 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

3. It is now difficult to force boats through the thick water hyacinth on Lake Victoria.

3 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

4. Chemicals produced by the water hyacinth plants are affecting the numbers of fish in Lake Victoria. 4 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

5. Cooking with charcoal has been proved to be even worse for people's health than cooking with wood. 5 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

6. People found it impossible to remove much water hyacinth from Lake Victoria.

6 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

7. Scientists started investigating the possibility of using water hyacinth to generate biogas in the last century. 7 (TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN)

Questions 8-10

Complete the flow-chart below.

Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 8-10 on your answer sheet.

Generating biogas for domestic use in Dunga

First, place water hyacinth together with some 8 into a digester

↓

Leave the mixture until the 9 is completed

↓

Capture the gas emitted by the digester and use 10 to transport it to individual homes

↓

Then use the gas for cooking as well as making water fit for human consumption

Questions 11-13

Complete the notes below.

Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

Write your answers in boxes 11-13 on your answer sheet.

Benefits for the women in the village of cooking with biogas

- no need for them to spend so much **11** collecting fuel
- they can focus on different tasks that bring in **12**
- they are less likely to experience certain diseases connected to burning wood

Drawbacks of changing to biogas

- the **13** of the digesters is beyond the reach of most villages

HOW COULD MULTILINGUALISM BENEFIT INDIA'S POOREST SCHOOLCHILDREN?

How could multilingualism benefit India's poorest schoolchildren?

The crowded and bustling streets of Delhi teem with life. Stop to listen and, above the din of rickshaws and buses, you'll hear a multitude of languages, as more than 20 million people go about their daily lives. Many were born and raised here, and many millions more have recently made India's capital their home, having moved from surrounding neighbourhoods, cities and states or across the country, often in the hope of gaining better jobs and a better life. Some arrive speaking fluent Hindi, the dominant language in Delhi (and the official language of government), but many arrive speaking any number of India's 22 officially recognised languages, let alone the hundreds of regional languages in a country of more than 1.3 billion people.

A team of researchers led by Professor Ianthi Tsimpli of Cambridge University is currently working on a project collecting data on 1,000 primary-age children in Delhi and the cities of Hyderabad and Bihar. The overriding aim of the four-year project, called 'Multilingualism and Multiliteracy', is to find out why in a country where multilingualism is so common (more than 255 million people in India speak at least two languages, and nearly 90 million speak three or more languages), the many benefits of speaking more than one language, observed in schools in Europe for instance, do not apply to many of India's schoolchildren.

'Each year across India, 600,000 children are tested, and year after year over 50% of children in Standard 5 [ten-year-olds] cannot read a Standard 2 [seven-year-olds] task fluently, and just under 50% of them cannot solve a Standard 2 subtraction task,' says Tsimpli. She explains that low educational achievement can lead to many of these students dropping out of school - a problem disproportionately affecting female students.

Tsimpli and her colleagues are investigating whether these low learning outcomes could be caused by an Indian school system where the language that children are taught in often differs from the language used at home. The research project, which focuses on 8 to 11-year-old schoolchildren in rural and urban areas, collects data on whether the schoolchildren live in slum* or non-slum areas. Many of the children have moved from remote, rural areas to urban areas. They are so poor they have to live in slums and, as a result of migration, they may speak languages that are different from the regional language.

* **slum:** a very densely populated area in which the infrastructure is incomplete and services inadequate or non-existent

Having already tested 1,000 children, the researchers will now embark on retesting them. They intend to look not only at test results, but also at variables such as the standard of schooling, the environment and the teaching practices themselves. It's possible that one of the causes of low performance is the lack of pupil-centred teaching methods; in many Indian primary schools the teacher dominates and there is little room for independent learning.

Although the findings are at a preliminary stage, Tsimpli and her team have found that the medium of instruction used in schools, especially English, may hold back those children who have little familiarity with, or exposure to, the language before starting school and outside of school life. According to Tsimpli, most of the evidence from this and other projects shows that English instruction for children from low socio-economic areas might not be the best way for them to learn, at least in the first three years of primary education.

'What we would recommend for everyone, not just low socio-economic status children, would be to start learning in the language they feel comfortable learning in ... English can still be used, but perhaps not as the medium of instruction in primary schools. It could, for example, be one of the subjects that are being taught alongside other subjects. We are not suggesting that English be withdrawn - that ship has sailed - but we perhaps have to think more about learner needs. There is perhaps too much uniformity in teaching and less tailoring to the children's language abilities and needs,' says Tsimpli.

While the preliminary results show there is no difference in general intelligence among boys and girls from slum areas versus those from urban poor backgrounds, an unanticipated finding has been that children from slum backgrounds do not seem to lag behind children from other urban poor backgrounds - and in some cases outperform them (e.g. in numeracy and literacy tasks). According to the researchers, this unexpected finding may be down to the life experiences of children growing up in slums. They are likely to mature faster and come into closer contact with the numeracy skills essential for day-to-day survival.

The project has already caught the attention of government ministers, who are keen to use the findings of the study to inform and adjust school policy in Delhi and the wider state. 'They are as keen as us to understand how the challenging context of deprivation can be attenuated when focusing on the languages children learn and use while at school. Our findings don't mean you're doomed if you're poor. It may be that these low learning outcomes are because of the way education is provided in India, with a huge focus on Hindi and English as the mediums of instruction, to the potential detriment of children unfamiliar with those languages,' explains Tsimpli.

'Language is central to the way knowledge is transferred - so the medium of instruction is obviously hugely influential. We hope to ... show that problem solving, numeracy and literacy can and do improve in children who are educated in a language of instruction they know. The trick may be to bridge school skills with life skills and make use of the richness of a child's life experience to help them learn in the most effective ways possible,' says Tsimpli.

Questions 14-19

Complete the summary using the list of words, A-J, below.

Write the correct letter, A-J, in boxes 14-19 on your answer sheet.

Multilingualism in Delhi

The city of Delhi has a **14** (A/B/C/D/E/F/G/H/I/J) and as you walk through its streets you hear people speaking a variety of languages. Some of them have spent their entire life in Delhi, while others are **15** (A/B/C/D/E/F/G/H/I/J). Whether they have come from a **16** (A/B/C/D/E/F/G/H/I/J) or have travelled from the other side of India, they have all come in search of things such as improved **17** (A/B/C/D/E/F/G/H/I/J).

A team of researchers led by Professor Ianthi Tsimpli of Cambridge University is collecting data on primary-age schoolchildren in Delhi and other Indian cities. The **18** (A/B/C/D/E/F/G/H/I/J) of the research is to discover why multilingual Indian schoolchildren do not experience **19** (A/B/C/D/E/F/G/H/I/J) to those that multilingual schoolchildren in Europe experience.

A	basic outlook
B	employment opportunities
C	wealthy visitors
D	distant country
E	primary objective
F	similar advantages
G	thriving economy
H	nearby district
I	dense population
J	new immigrants

Questions 20-23

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 2?

In boxes 20-23 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer

NO — if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

20. Ten-year-old Indian schoolchildren tend to perform better in literacy tests than in numeracy tests.

20 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

21. Tsimpli had problems convincing some female students to take part in the study.

21 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

22. Tsimpli and her team wanted to know if there is a connection between poor academic performance and being taught in an unfamiliar language. **22** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

23. The researchers have decided against investigating the impact teaching methodology may have on learning outcomes. **23** (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

Questions 24-26

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

Write the correct letter in boxes 24-26 on your answer sheet.

24. What point does the writer make about primary schools in India in the sixth paragraph?

- A** Exposure to English outside of school is of limited benefit.
- B** Children learn English more easily when they are well motivated.
- C** Poor children may be disadvantaged further by being instructed in English.
- D** There is little consistency across schools with regard to instruction in English.

24 (A / B / C / D)

25. What is Tsimpli suggesting when she uses the phrase 'that ship has sailed'?

- A** The findings of the report may be of little help to some Indian schoolchildren.
- B** Instruction in English could be better adapted to the needs of schoolchildren.
- C** Schools have had limited success in teaching English as a separate subject.
- D** It is too late to remove English completely as a language of instruction in schools.

25 (A / B / C / D)

26. In the eighth paragraph, what do we learn has surprised researchers?

- A** Boys and girls from low socio-economic groups have similar general intelligence levels.
- B** The age at which children move into a slum does not affect their academic performance.
- C** Slum children and children from other urban poor backgrounds have similar life experiences.
- D** The literacy and numeracy skills of slum children are not lower than those of children from other urban poor backgrounds.

26 (A / B / C / D)

THE GLOBEMAKERS: THE CURIOUS STORY OF AN ANCIENT CRAFT

The Globemakers: The Curious Story of an Ancient Craft

A review of Peter Bellerby's book *The Globemakers*

In 2008, Peter Bellerby, who lived in London, wanted to give his father a model globe for his eightieth birthday. What seemed simple enough to start with triggered an almost obsessive, decade-long journey, marked by a series of obstacles that would have deterred anyone less determined. It ended with his establishing the world's only bespoke globemaking company.

The first surprise in *The Globemakers*, Bellerby's account of this impulsive enterprise, is that obtaining such a globe was not simply a matter of a quick online order and a repressed sigh at the shipping costs. After all, contrary to stubbornly held popular views of our ancestors' geographical ignorance, we have known that the world is spherical since at least the 6th century BCE. The ancient Greek philosopher Plato in his work *Phaedo* likened it to a leather ball, while the accolade of producing the first recorded globe goes to the ancient Greek philosopher Crates of Mallus, who is said to have made one in around 150 BCE. Surely, Bellerby reasoned, a good-quality globe wouldn't be difficult to find.

Nearly two millennia later, however, it seemed that the art of globemaking had been largely forgotten. Bellerby came across shoddy commercial versions designed for school classrooms and genuine antiques in auction houses that would have bust his budget. Even his trips to Morocco and India, where surely the knowledge of artisan cartographers* had been preserved, drew a blank.

Not one to be easily thwarted, Bellerby decided to make his own good-quality globe. In the process, almost everything that could possibly go wrong did so. Even the shape of the Earth posed a problem, as it is not quite a perfect sphere, but oblate (slightly flattened at the poles). Having decided to compromise and opt for two half-spherical pieces that could be fitted together, he was unable to discover anyone capable of casting moulds with sufficient accuracy to ensure that he would not be left with two half-spheres that were not quite the same circumference. Even after he eventually resolved this issue, extracting these from the moulds resulted in piles of cracked plaster of Paris** and clouds of choking dust in the workshop he had set up at the rear of his house.

This series of abortive experiments taught Bellerby a lot about the challenges of making globes, which he communicates here to the reader. Finding just the right way to prise the globes from the mould - a high-end air compressor finally did the trick - and locating the right paper and inks with which to make the gores (the sections of flat sheet mapping that are pasted onto the spherical globe) without the ink seeping out to create a mushy, unreadable mess took months and an alarming chunk out of his bank balance. Bellerby's frustration at the painstaking process of attaching the gores to the globe surface - after having found a glue with precisely the right adhesive qualities - is palpable. Right at the end of the process, he learnt that the paper had stretched slightly and so the final one overlapped the first by a centimetre (which may not seem a great deal, but when that represents 2 per cent of the Earth's diameter, it's equivalent to obliterating the Himalayas or wiping out Chile).

Bellerby's account of the technical challenges of globe production is interspersed with a series of interludes on great globemakers of the past and cartographic history in general. Purists might wish for more map-making details, but Bellerby clearly found a kindred spirit in Martin Behaim. He was the Nuremberg entrepreneur who in 1492 created the Erdapfel, the world's oldest surviving globe, beautifully finished by a workshop of painters and other craftsmen, only to find that the explorer Christopher Columbus had stumbled upon the Americas the very same year, rendering his masterpiece instantly out of

date. Something of Bellerby's unflinching ambition is reflected in the even more heroic efforts of the Italian cartographer Vincenzo Coronelli, who, in the seventeenth century, created two globes for Louis XIV of France. It took him twenty years to complete the monstrous pair, whose vast bulk - each with a diameter of around four metres - can still be admired in the National Library of France in Paris.

Although a celebration of the revival of an ancient craft, Bellerby's book is also a lament for the fading away of centuries-old traditions. When he embarked on his globemaking odyssey, he struggled to find artisans with the skills to make the right moulds for the globes or foundries that could shape the meridians (the metal frames which girdle globes) in just the right way. Although he finally located the right craftsmen, some simply dropping in, serendipitously, to his workshop (by now in more suitable premises than his back room), many of these have now retired or passed away.

Bellerby's father finally did receive his eightieth birthday present, albeit two years late. Bellerby went on to found a company which now turns out over six hundred globes a year for customers who can have their own tiny village marked or more unusual requests fulfilled. His book, beautifully illustrated with photographs of the various stages of his venture and a few illustrations of historic globes and maps, is hardly a blueprint for commercial success. But it is more than enough to stir up admiration for the craftsmanship of the great mapmakers of the past and the obsessive determination of a modern successor who revived their almost moribund art.

* **cartographer:** someone involved in the science or practice of drawing maps

** **plaster of Paris:** a quick-setting plaster consisting of a fine white powder that hardens when moistened and allowed to dry

Questions 27-32

Complete the summary using the list of words, A-J, below.

Write the correct letter, A-J, in boxes 27-32 on your answer sheet.

A. educational use	B. rare materials	C. inferior makes
D. product exchange	E. necessary skills	F. international markets
G. challenging task	H. memorable object	I. internet purchase
J. numerous problems		

A birthday gift

Peter Bellerby's plan to give his father a globe for his birthday was an unexpectedly

27 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I / J) for which he had to overcome

28 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I / J).

He soon learnt that a straightforward **29** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I / J) would not be possible.

Some **30** (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I / J) that had been intended for

31 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I / J) were available, as were some expensive antique globes, but these were beyond his budget.

He even travelled to places where people might still have the

32 (A / B / C / D / E / F / G / H / I / J), but Bellerby could not find what he wanted.

Questions 33-36

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 33-36 on your answer sheet, write

YES if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

33. The assumption today that people in the past knew very little about geography is correct.

33 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

34. Plato was criticised for saying the world was shaped like a leather ball.

34 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

35. The globe made by Crates of Mallus was an accurate representation of the known world.

35 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

36. Bellerby assumed he would have few problems locating a well-made globe.

36 (YES / NO / NOT GIVEN)

Questions 37–40

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** or **D**.

Write the correct letter in boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet.

37. When Bellerby had to attach the gores to the globe surface,

- A** he decided it was best to work quickly.
- B** he became aware of an unexpected issue.
- C** he was worried about the quality of his materials.
- D** he nearly gave up the whole project.

37 (A / B / C / D)

38. The reviewer mentions other globe makers of the past because

- A** Bellerby was particularly inspired by them.
- B** their achievements are not widely known.
- C** Bellerby had something in common with each of them.
- D** their difficulties could have been avoided.

38 (A / B / C / D)

39. What point is made about Bellerby in the seventh paragraph?

- A** He had long working relationships with numerous craftsmen.
- B** He understands the lack of interest in traditional crafts.
- C** He appreciates the importance of careful planning.
- D** He regrets the loss of many globe-making skills.

39 (A / B / C / D)

40. What does the reviewer say about Bellerby's book in the final paragraph?

- A** It does not tell you how to create a profitable business.
- B** It overlooks some important mapmakers.
- C** It fails to discuss the future of globe-making.
- D** It does not give enough details about individual customers.

40 (A / B / C / D)



Done? Scan to check your answers

Now that you've answered every question, scan to see the answer key online — or upload a photo of your answer sheet and we'll mark it and add it to your account.

<https://keenielts.com/check/reading/zaPWcRr2cNkURRe6FdxW>

Reading Answer Sheet — Practice Test 4



Scan to mark this sheet & save it to your account

SHEET ID

R-zaPWcRr2cNkURRe6FdxW

Name: _____ Date: _____

1	_____	21	_____
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8	_____	28	_____
9	_____	29	_____
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13	_____	33	_____
14	_____	34	_____
15	_____	35	_____
16	_____	36	_____
17	_____	37	_____
18	_____	38	_____
19	_____	39	_____
20	_____	40	_____

Writing

2 tasks · 60 minutes

TASK 1

LIBRARY USER SURVEY RESULTS

You should **spend about 20 minutes** on this task.

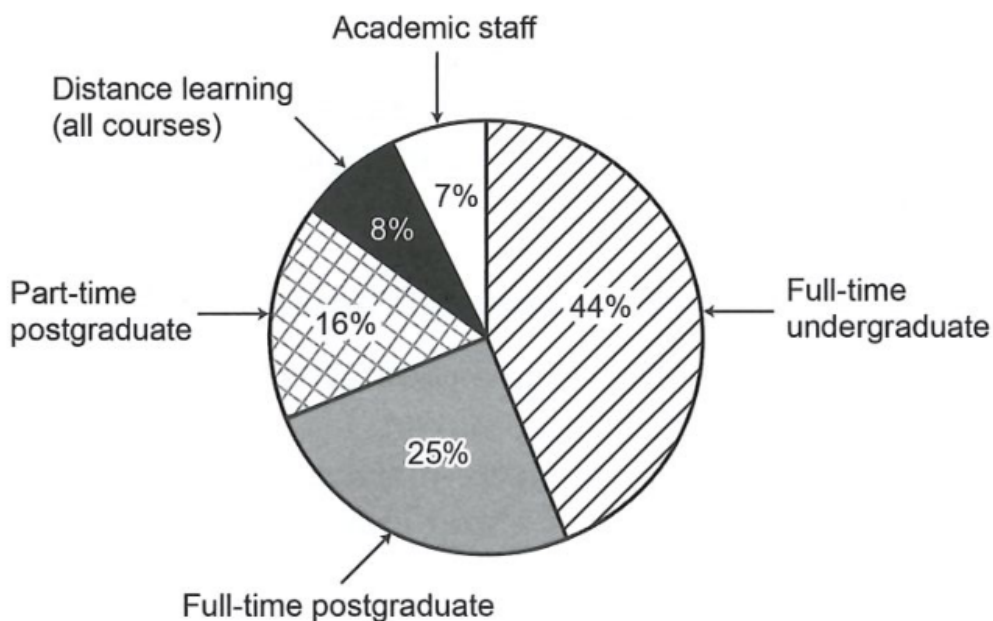
Write at least 150 words.

The chart and table below show the results of a survey of library users at a university.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Categories of library users

Categories of library users



Library user satisfaction (%)

	Very satisfied	Fairly satisfied	Not satisfied
Library opening hours	65	35	0
Helpfulness of staff	95	5	0
Availability of books	50	40	10
Availability of journals	45	35	20
Reliability of wi-fi	48	33	19



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 1? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 4 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/rCbuEXTjtJPkVMs7MRI?task=T1>



Sheet ID: W-rCbuEXtjiTJPkVMs7MRI-T1

TASK 2

PRIMARY SCHOOL FOCUS ON FORMAL LEARNING

You should **spend about 40 minutes** on this task.

Write at least 250 words.

Some people argue that primary schools focus too much on formal learning.

To what extent do you agree with this opinion?

How important do you think it is for children to play as well as learn in the primary school classroom?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.



Scan to see the model answers

Finished Task 2? Scan to read high-band model answers for Cambridge IELTS 21 · Practice Test 4 and compare them with your own.

<https://keenielts.com/check/writing/rCbuEXtjtJPkVMs7MRI?task=T2>



Sheet ID: W-rCbuEXtjiTJPkVMs7MRI-T2

Speaking

3 parts · 11–14 minutes · practise aloud, ideally with a partner or recorder

PART 1

BREAD

1. Can you tell me your full name, please?
2. What can I call you?
3. Where are you from?
4. Do you work, or are you a student?
5. When do you usually eat bread?
6. How important is bread in your culture?
7. Have you tried any kinds of bread from other countries?
8. Would you be interested in learning how to make bread?

PART 2

DESCRIBE A PERSON YOU KNOW WHO IS VERY COMPETITIVE

Describe a person you know who is very competitive.

You should say:

- who this person is
- what this person is competitive about
- how successful this person is

and explain why you think this person is so competitive.

You have one minute to prepare. Then speak for 1–2 minutes.

PART 3

COMPETITIONS AND BEING COMPETITIVE IN SPORTS

1. What kinds of competitions do people like to enter in your country?
2. What do you think is the best kind of prize to win in a competition?
3. Why do people like watching quiz shows and other competitions on TV?
4. How important is it to be very competitive at sport?
5. Do you think sportspeople perform better when they play against competitors who are stronger than they are?

6. Why do some people think that taking part in sport is more important than winning?



Scan to record & get an AI band score

Practised these questions aloud? Scan to record your answers on your phone and get an instant AI speaking evaluation across all four criteria.

<https://keenielts.com/check/speaking/PN7JZUFLcLaPUr724E7R>